

SS2 LITERATURE-IN-ENGLISH LESSON NOTES

FIRST TERM

WEEK 1: INTRODUCTION TO AFRICAN POETRY

TOPIC: GABRIEL OKARA – "ONCE UPON A TIME"

1.1 ABOUT THE POET: GABRIEL OKARA (1921-2019)

Gabriel Okara was a Nigerian poet and novelist, often referred to as one of the "fathers" of modern African literature. Born in the Ijaw-speaking region of the Niger Delta, his work is deeply influenced by the folklore, religion, and worldview of his people. His poetry is celebrated for its lyrical, simple, and direct style, which often explores the tensions between traditional African culture and the encroaching influence of Western modernization.

1.2 THE POEM: "ONCE UPON A TIME"

"Once Upon a Time" is a poignant (sadly reflective) poem structured as a monologue. A father is speaking to his son, lamenting the loss of innocence and sincerity in the modern world. He contrasts the open, genuine emotions of the past ("once upon a time") with the fake, cold, and calculated social interactions of the present.

1.3 CONTENT ANALYSIS (STANZA-BY-STANZA)

- **Stanza 1:** The poem opens with the classic fairy-tale phrase, "Once upon a time, son." The persona recalls a time when people "used to laugh with their hearts / and laugh with their eyes." This was a genuine, full-bodied laugh. Now, they "only laugh with their teeth," a superficial, mechanical action, while their "ice-block-cold eyes / search behind my shadow." This is a powerful image of suspicion and insincerity.
- **Stanza 2:** He remembers a time when people's handshakes were genuine. Now, when people shake hands "without hearts," they use their "left hand" to "search my empty pockets." The handshake, a traditional sign of welcome, has become a tool of exploitation.

- **Stanza 3:** The phrase "Feel at home!" used to be sincere. Now, it's a hollow invitation. If you visit more than twice, you will find the "doors shut on me." Modern hospitality is superficial and conditional.
- **Stanza 4:** The persona confesses that he, too, has been forced to adapt to this new, fake world. He has learned to "wear many faces / like dresses." He has a "homeface," "officeface," "cocktailface," all "conforming smiles / like a fixed portrait smile." He has lost his single, true identity and now navigates the world with a series of masks.
- **Stanza 5:** He admits he has mastered the art of insincerity. He has learned to "laugh with only my teeth" and "shake hands without my heart." He has also learned to say "Goodbye" when he means "Good-riddance" and "Glad to meet you" without being glad at all.
- **Stanza 6:** This is the climax of his lament. He states that all these "conforming" behaviours have made him false. He wants to be his old self again, but he "can't unlearn" what he has learned. He finds his own new self-repulsive, comparing his smile to a "snake's bare fangs," an image of hidden danger and poison.
- **Stanza 7:** The poem ends with a desperate plea to his son, who still possesses the innocence the father has lost. He asks the son to "show me, son, / how to laugh; show me how / I used to laugh and smile / once upon a time when I was like you." It is a tragic reversal of roles, where the father must learn true, uncorrupted emotion from his child.

1.4 THEMES

1. **Loss of Innocence and Sincerity:** This is the central theme. The poem mourns the death of genuine emotion, honesty, and trust.
2. **Cultural Conflict / The Hypocrisy of Modernity:** The poem contrasts the "old" traditional African values (warmth, trust) with the "new" Western-influenced modern world (coldness, suspicion, individualism).
3. **Nostalgia:** The persona longs for the past ("once upon a time"), not just for a specific time, but for a specific *way of being* that has been lost.
4. **Conformity and Loss of Identity:** The persona has lost his true self by conforming to the "faces" and fake smiles required by society.

1.5 POETIC DEVICES

1. **Simile:** A direct comparison using "like" or "as."
 - "...conforming smiles / *like* a fixed portrait smile." (Shows artificiality, stiffness).
2. **Metaphor:** An indirect comparison.
 - "laugh with their teeth" (Laughter as a mechanical, tooth-baring gesture, not a heartfelt emotion).
 - "ice-block-cold eyes" (Eyes as cold, unfeeling objects).
 - "I have learned to wear many faces / like dresses" (This is both a simile and a metaphor, where identities are compared to clothing that can be changed).
 - "...my laugh in the mirror... / shows only my teeth *like a snake's bare fangs*." (A simile comparing his smile to a snake's fangs, symbolizing his self-disgust and the poison of insincerity).
3. **Imagery:** Language that appeals to the senses.
 - **Visual Imagery:** "ice-block-cold eyes," "many faces," "portrait smile," "snake's bare fangs."
 - **Tactile (Touch) Imagery:** The "cold" eyes, the handshake "without hearts."
4. **Repetition:** The poet repeats key phrases for emphasis.
 - "Once upon a time..." (Sets the nostalgic, fairy-tale tone).
 - "laugh with their..." (Emphasizes the change in laughter).
5. **Symbolism:**
 - **The Son:** Symbolizes innocence, purity, the uncorrupted past.
 - **The Snake:** Symbolizes deceit, danger, and the persona's corruption.

EVALUATION

1. What is the central contrast in the poem?
2. Explain the metaphor "ice-block-cold eyes."
3. What does the persona mean when he says he has learned to "wear many faces"?
4. Why does the persona ask his son to "show me how to laugh"?

ASSIGNMENT

1. Identify and explain three (3) major themes in "Once Upon a Time."
2. In two paragraphs, discuss the poet's use of language and imagery to portray the insincerity of the modern world.



WEEK 2: AFRICAN POETRY

TOPIC: WOLE SOYINKA – "NIGHT"

2.1 ABOUT THE POET: WOLE SOYINKA (B. 1934)

Wole Soyinka is a Nigerian playwright, novelist, poet, and essayist. In 1986, he was awarded the Nobel Prize in Literature, the first sub-Saharan African to be so honoured. Soyinka's writing is often complex, dense, and "metaphysical" (dealing with spiritual or abstract ideas). He draws heavily from Yoruba mythology, particularly the god Ogun, to explore themes of life, death, and human struggle.

2.2 THE POEM: "NIGHT"

"Night" is a short, intense, and atmospheric poem. It is not just about the *time* of night, but about the *experience* of being enveloped and transformed by the darkness. The persona describes a mystical, almost frightening surrender to the power of the night.

2.3 CONTENT ANALYSIS & THEMES

- **Content:** The persona feels the night approaching and surrounding him. His "skin" is "receptive," like a "womb," ready to be filled by the night's "supple, seamless" presence. This immersion is so total that he feels his own body dissolving or changing. His hand is "plucked from the myth of your body," meaning he feels disconnected from his own physical self. He becomes part of the landscape, describing himself as a "slow, bell-tapered mountain." He is no longer just a man; he is a feature of the night, listening to the "choir of ant-voices" (the tiny, hidden sounds of the dark).
- **Themes:**
 1. **The Overwhelming Power of Nature:** Night is not passive. It is an active, "supple," and all-consuming force.
 2. **Surrender and Loss of Self:** The persona does not fight the night; he surrenders to it. This leads to a loss of his individual identity ("plucked from the myth of your body") as he merges with his surroundings.

3. **Awe and Dread:** The experience is both mystical (like a "womb") and frightening ("cold as spray," "darkness"). The persona is in awe of the night's power.
4. **Transformation:** The persona is transformed by the experience, from a human individual into a "mountain," a permanent part of the night's landscape.

2.4 STRUCTURE

The poem is written as a **single, unbroken stanza**. This structure is significant. It mirrors the "seamless" and "supple" nature of the night itself. There are no breaks, just as there are no breaks in the total darkness, creating a feeling of intensity and immersion for the reader.

2.5 POETIC DEVICES

1. **Personification:** Night is given human (or at least active) qualities. It is a "supple, seamless" presence.
2. **Metaphor:**
 - "my skin... a receptive womb" (The persona's body is a place where the night can be "born" or take shape).
 - "Your hand... is plucked from the myth of your body" (The self is a "myth," a story that can be unmade; the hand is "plucked" like a fruit, suggesting effortless removal).
 - "I am... a slow, bell-tapered mountain" (The persona *becomes* the landscape).
3. **Imagery:** The poem is built on dark, tactile, and aural imagery.
 - **Tactile Imagery (Touch):** "Your hand... cold as spray," "supple, seamless," "receptive womb."
 - **Visual Imagery:** "Darkness, on stone surfaces."
 - **Aural Imagery (Sound):** "A choir of ant-voices" (A powerful image suggesting the tiny, hidden sounds of the night, amplified by the persona's new, non-human senses).
4. **Simile:** "Your hand... cold *as* spray."
5. **Alliteration:** Repetition of consonant sounds.

- "supple, seamless."
 - "Darkness... / drapes."
6. **Tone/Mood:** The tone is one of **awe** and **resignation**. The mood is **mystical, ominous, and transformative**.

EVALUATION

1. What is the significance of the poem being written in a single stanza?
2. Explain the metaphor, "I am... a slow, bell-tapered mountain."
3. What is the poet's attitude towards "Night"? Is he afraid of it?
4. What does the phrase "a choir of ant-voices" suggest?

ASSIGNMENT

1. Write a detailed paragraph on the theme of "Loss of Self" in Wole Soyinka's "Night."
2. Identify and explain three (3) poetic devices Soyinka uses to create the poem's mystical mood.

WEEK 3: AFRICAN POETRY

TOPIC: NIYI OSUNDARE – "NOT MY BUSINESS"

3.1 ABOUT THE POET: NIYI OSUNDARE (B. 1947)

Niyi Osundare is a prolific Nigerian poet, dramatist, and literary critic. He is a "second-generation" poet, whose work is characterized by its accessible language, performance-based rhythms, and strong social and political conscience. He writes for the "common man" and sees poetry as a tool for social change.

3.2 THE POEM: "NOT MY BUSINESS"

"Not My Business" is a narrative poem that serves as a powerful political parable. It warns against the dangers of political apathy (indifference) in the face of oppression. The persona witnesses several injustices but refuses to get involved, repeating the refrain "Not my business." His apathy comes back to haunt him when the oppressors finally come for him, and there is no one left to speak up.

3.3 CONTENT ANALYSIS (STANZA-BY-STANZA)

- **Stanza 1:** The persona sees "them" (the oppressors) beat up Akanni (a Yoruba name) and bundle him into a "waiting jeep." The persona does nothing because it's "not my business." He instead focuses on his "yam," a symbol of personal, material comfort.
- **Stanza 2:** "They" came for Danladi (a Hausa name), who was "dumped" in a "gallows-bound" jeep. Again, the persona does nothing, focusing on his "cup of garri" (another symbol of basic survival and comfort).
- **Stanza 3:** "They" came for Chinwe (an Igbo name), "muzzling" her. The persona notes his jeep (a symbol of his own relative wealth and comfort) is "safe" and isn't "gallows-bound." He is only concerned with *his* own property and well-being.
 - **Significance of Names:** Akanni, Danladi, and Chinwe represent the three major ethnic groups in Nigeria. This shows that the oppression is widespread and affects everyone, while the persona's apathy crosses all ethnic lines.

- **Stanza 4 (The Climax):** A "cold" boot (a symbol of military or police oppression) finally kicks down the persona's *own* door. The knock is "final and awesome." The oppressors have come for *him*.
- **Stanza 5:** In the final, desperate stanza, the persona looks for his "yam," "garri," and "jeep," but they are gone. His material comforts cannot save him. The "waiting jeep," once a distant problem for others, is now waiting *for him*. His "business" has finally "driven home," but it is too late.

3.4 THEMES

1. **The Danger of Political Apathy:** This is the core theme. The poem is a warning that "what concerns all, concerns all." Turning a blind eye to injustice only guarantees that the injustice will spread.
2. **Social Responsibility and Solidarity:** The poem argues that citizens have a duty to speak up for one another. The persona's failure is a failure of solidarity.
3. **Injustice and Oppression:** The poem depicts a state of fear, where people are "beaten," "dumped," and "muzzled" by an unnamed, oppressive force (symbolized by the "jeep").
4. **Fear and Selfishness:** The persona's apathy is driven by a combination of fear and a selfish desire to protect his own "yam," "garri," and "jeep."

3.5 STYLE, TONE, AND POETIC DEVICES

- **Style:** The poem is written in **simple, accessible language**. Osundare uses everyday words to make his message clear to everyone. It is a **narrative poem** (it tells a story).
- **Tone:** The tone is **casual, indifferent, and callous** (uncaring) in the first three stanzas. This is created by the persona's simple statements and his focus on food. The tone shifts dramatically in the final two stanzas to one of **panic, fear, and desperation**.
- **Poetic Devices:**
 1. **Refrain (Repetition):** The phrase "Not my business" is repeated at the end of the first three stanzas. This repetition highlights the persona's stubborn indifference and builds a sense of dramatic irony, as the reader knows this attitude is wrong.
 2. **Symbolism:**

- **Yam / Garri:** Represent basic, selfish material comfort and survival.
 - **Jeep:** Represents state power, oppression, and menace.
3. **Irony:** The ultimate irony is that by *not* making the suffering of others his "business," the persona's *own* suffering becomes the "business" of the oppressors.
 4. **Diction:** The words used for the oppressors are harsh: "beat," "dumped," "muzzled," "kicked." The words for the persona are mundane: "eating," "sipping," "safe." This contrast highlights his disconnect.

EVALUATION

1. What is the poem's central message about political apathy?
2. What is the effect of the refrain, "Not my business"?
3. What do the "yam" and "garri" symbolize?
4. How does the poet use the names Akanni, Danladi, and Chinwe to make a national point?
5. Describe the change in tone in the last two stanzas.

ASSIGNMENT

1. Write two paragraphs discussing how Niyi Osundare uses irony and symbolism to convey his message.
2. In your own words, explain the lesson the persona learns at the end of the poem.

WEEK 4: AFRICAN POETRY

TOPIC: SYL CHENEY-COKER – "THE BREAST OF THE SEA"

4.1 ABOUT THE POET: SYL CHENEY-COKER (B. 1945)

Syl Cheney-Coker is one of Sierra Leone's most prominent poets. His work is deeply influenced by the experience of exile, the history of the African diaspora (the scattering of African peoples, often through the slave trade), and a "Creole" identity. His poetry often has a passionate, fiery, and sometimes surreal quality.

4.2 THE POEM: "THE BREAST OF THE SEA"

This poem is a powerful, passionate **ode** (a poem of praise) to the sea. The persona, who identifies as an African ("the son of your womb"), addresses the sea as a "goddess" and a "mother." The sea is not just a body of water; it is the source of his identity, the holder of his people's history, and a powerful, dualistic (two-sided) force of both creation and destruction.

4.3 CONTENT ANALYSIS

- The persona begins by praising the "barbaric... beautiful" nature of the sea, acknowledging its dual power. He calls it a "goddess" and a "virgin mother," suggesting it is a primal, self-sustaining force.
- He identifies himself as "the son of your womb," meaning he sees the sea as the *origin* of his race.
- He finds his own "memory" and the "history" of his people within the sea. This is a powerful allusion to the **Middle Passage**—the journey of slave ships across the Atlantic. The sea became the "breast" that "nurtured" those who survived and the grave that holds the "memory" of those who died.
- He speaks of the "salt on my lips" as a "memory of my race." The salt symbolizes the **bitterness and pain** of that history, but also its *preservative* quality. The sea preserves the memory.

- He contrasts the sea's "infinity" (eternity) with the "trivial" concerns of the land. The land is "sterile" and "unprocreative," but the sea is the "womb" of his people.
- He ends by reaffirming his devotion, promising to return to its "altar," to worship it as the source of his inspiration and identity.

4.4 THEMES

1. **The Sea as a Source of Identity and Origin:** The central theme is that the sea is the "womb" of the African diaspora. It is the mother of the persona's race.
2. **Ancestral Memory and History:** The sea is a living archive. It holds the "memory" of the African people, particularly the trauma and resilience associated with the slave trade.
3. **The Duality of Nature:** The sea is "barbaric" (violent, stormy, destructive) and "beautiful" (calm, life-giving, infinite). It is both a "virgin mother" and a "terrible" force.
4. **Longing for Roots (The Diaspora Experience):** The poem expresses the deep spiritual connection that the diaspora (those "scattered" from Africa) feels to the sea, as it is the very thing that connects and separates them from their "homeland."

4.5 IMAGERY AND SYMBOLISM

1. **Central Metaphor:** The poem is built on the central metaphor of **the sea as a mother/goddess**. This is explicit in phrases like "virgin mother," "son of your womb," and, most importantly, "the breast of the sea."
 - **"The Breast of the Sea":** This is a complex metaphor. A breast provides *nurture* and *life* (milk). For the persona, the sea nurtures his identity and his art. It is a source of comfort and belonging.
2. **Symbolism:**
 - **The Sea:** Represents origin, eternity, memory, history, and the African diaspora.
 - **Salt:** Symbolizes the bitter pain of history (slavery) and the preservation of memory.
3. **Imagery:**
 - **Visual:** "barbaric... beautiful," "mangroves," "sun's eye."
 - **Gustatory (Taste):** "the salt on my lips."

4. **Personification:** The sea is personified throughout as a goddess and mother whom the persona can address directly.
5. **Juxtaposition (Contrast):** The poet constantly places opposing ideas together to show the sea's complexity:
 - "barbaric" vs. "beautiful"
 - "infinity" (sea) vs. "trivial" (land)

EVALUATION

1. What is the poet's main attitude towards the sea?
2. Explain the complex metaphor "the breast of the sea."
3. What historical event does the poem allude to when it talks about the "memory of my race" found in the sea?
4. What does the "salt" symbolize to the persona?

ASSIGNMENT

1. Discuss the theme of "Ancestral Memory" in "The Breast of the Sea."
2. Identify and explain the poet's use of personification and juxtaposition in the poem.

WEEK 5: MIDTERM EXAMINATION

(This week is for the assessment of all topics covered in Weeks 1-4. No new lesson notes.)



WEEK 6: AFRICAN POETRY (COMPARATIVE STUDY)

TOPIC 1: S.O.H. AFRIYIE-VIDZA – "HEARTY GARLANDS"

6.1 ABOUT THE POET

S.O.H. Afriyie-Vidza is a contemporary Ghanaian poet. His work is not as widely known as the others, but it often explores personal emotions, love, and social life with a sincere and direct voice.

6.2 CONTENT, THEMES, AND TONE

- **Content:** This is a simple, direct, and sincere **love poem**. The persona is addressing his beloved, presenting "hearty garlands" (wreaths of flowers) as a symbol of his love. These garlands are special because they are "watered" not just by "showers of grace" (good times), but by his "faithful tears" and "sweat" (bad times and hard work).
- **Theme:** The central theme is **enduring and resilient love**. This is not a new, flighty love; it is a mature love that has been "nurtured" and strengthened by shared hardships ("tears" and "sweat"). The love is "beautiful" *because* it has survived.
- **Mood and Tone:** The mood is **celebratory** and **joyful**. The tone is **sincere, affectionate, and grateful**.

6.3 POETIC DEVICES

1. Symbolism/Metaphor:

- **"Garlands":** The central symbol for the poet's love.
- **"Watered":** The love is a living plant that has been "nurtured."
- **"Tears" and "Sweat":** Symbols of hardship, sacrifice, and the difficulties they have overcome together.

2. Diction (Word Choice):

The words are all positive and warm: "hearty," "faithful," "beautiful," "grace."

TOPIC 2: ELIZABETH L. A. KAMARA – "NEW TONGUE"

6.4 ABOUT THE POET

Elizabeth L. A. Kamara is a modern poet from Sierra Leone. Her work often explores issues of identity, gender, and the challenges of navigating different cultures.

6.5 CONTENT, THEMES, AND TONE

- **Content:** This poem describes the painful and alienating experience of **adopting a foreign language and culture**. The "new tongue" (likely English) is "bitter" in her mouth. She contrasts it with her "mother tongue," which she has "spat out" and "buried." This new language is "cold," and her own people "cannot hear" her. She feels like an impostor, and her attempts to speak the new language "slip" and "falter."
- **Themes:**
 1. **Cultural Alienation:** The "new tongue" separates her from her own people.
 2. **Loss of Identity:** Language is a core part of identity. In "burying" her mother tongue, she has lost a part of herself.
 3. **The Pain of Assimilation:** The poem shows that "fitting in" to a new (often dominant or colonial) culture is not a simple or happy process; it is painful and difficult.
- **Mood and Tone:** The mood is **melancholy** and **isolating**. The tone is **sad, frustrated, and alienated**.

6.6 POETIC DEVICES

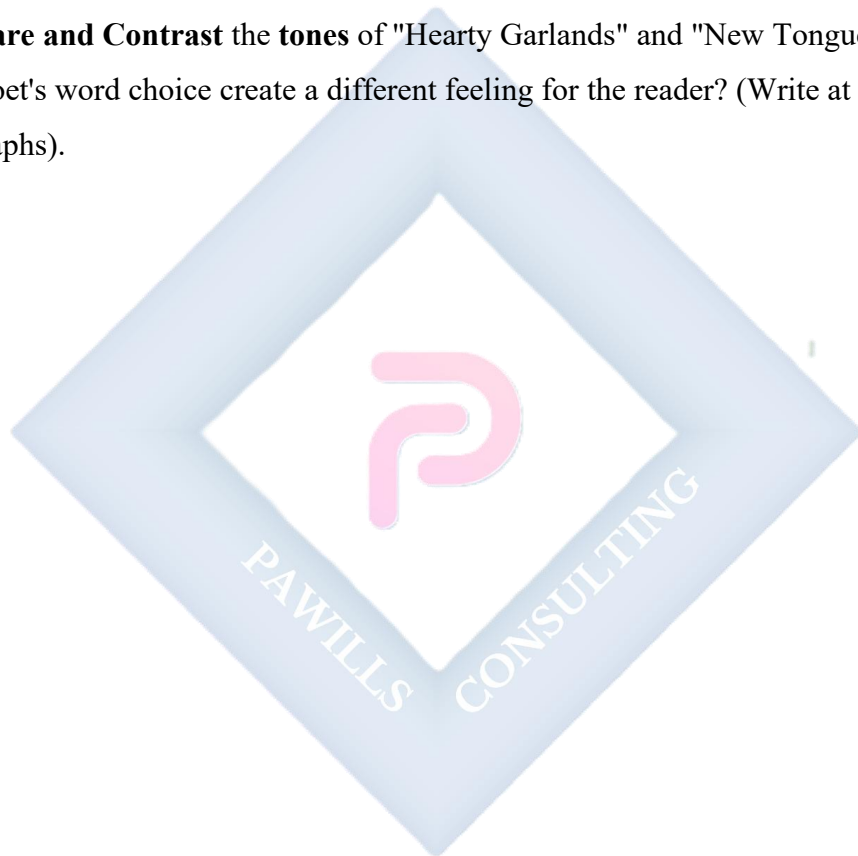
1. **Central Metaphor:** The "new tongue" is the metaphor for the foreign language and its associated culture.
2. **Imagery:** The poem is built on sensory, negative imagery.
 - **Gustatory (Taste):** "bitter"
 - **Tactile (Touch):** "cold"
 - **Aural (Sound):** "my people... cannot hear"
3. **Juxtaposition (Contrast):** The entire poem is a contrast between the "new tongue" (bitter, cold, slipping) and the implied "mother tongue" (natural, warm, lost).

EVALUATION

1. What is the central theme of "Hearty Garlands"?
2. In "Hearty Garlands," what makes the "garlands" so special and strong?
3. What is the "new tongue" that the persona in Kamara's poem is describing?
4. Describe the persona's feelings about this "new tongue."

ASSIGNMENT

1. **Compare and Contrast** the **tones** of "Hearty Garlands" and "New Tongue." How does each poet's word choice create a different feeling for the reader? (Write at least two paragraphs).



WEEK 7: MIDTERM BREAK

(This week is a break. No new lesson notes.)



WEEK 8: NON-AFRICAN POETRY

TOPIC: MAYA ANGELOU – "STILL I RISE"

8.1 ABOUT THE POET: MAYA ANGELOU (1928-2014)

Maya Angelou was a highly celebrated American poet, memoirist, and civil rights activist. Her work is known for its powerful rhythms, its accessibility, and its unwavering themes of Black (and female) identity, resilience, and empowerment. "Still I Rise" is one of her most famous and beloved poems.

8.2 THE POEM: "STILL I RISE"

"Still I Rise" is an anthem of **defiance and triumph**. The persona, speaking as a Black woman, directly confronts her oppressors ("You"). She lists all the ways "you" try to "write me down in history," "shoot me with your words," and "kill me with your hatefulness," but defiantly declares that *despite* all this, she will rise.

8.3 THEMES

1. **Resilience and Perseverance:** This is the core theme. The persona is "trod in the very dirt" but, "like dust," she will "rise." She is unstoppable.
2. **Empowerment:** The poem is a declaration of self-worth and power, particularly for Black women who face the dual oppression of racism and sexism.
3. **Defiance Against Oppression:** The persona is not a passive victim. She is sassy, taunting, and defiant, challenging her oppressors with rhetorical questions.
4. **In-domitable (Unbeatable) Human Spirit:** The poem is a universal celebration of the human spirit's ability to overcome any and all adversity.

8.4 POETIC TECHNIQUES

1. **Direct Address (Apostrophe):** The persona speaks directly to "You." This makes the poem confrontational and powerful. "You may write me down in history..."

2. **Refrain (Repetition):** The phrases "Still I'll rise" and "Still I rise" are repeated throughout, acting as a powerful, drum-beat-like anchor that builds in intensity.
3. **Simile:** The poem is famous for its proud and defiant similes.
 - "But still, *like dust*, I'll rise." (Dust is common, it's looked down on, but it is impossible to keep down).
 - "'Cause I laugh *like I've got gold mines / Diggin' in my own backyard*."
 - "'Cause I walk *like I've got oil wells / Pumping in my living room*." (These similes show her indestructible inner worth and power, regardless of what oppressors think).
4. **Metaphor:**
 - "I'm a black ocean, leaping and wide, / Welling and swelling I bear in the tide." (A powerful metaphor for her deep, vast, and unstoppable natural power).
5. **Rhetorical Questions:** She taunts her oppressors with questions she doesn't expect an answer to.
 - "Does my sassiness upset you?"
 - "Does my haughtiness offend you?"
 - "Did you want to see me broken?"
6. **Tone:** The tone is **proud, defiant, sassy, joyous, triumphant, and unapologetic**.

EVALUATION

1. Who is the "You" the poet is addressing in the poem?
2. What is the effect of the refrain "Still I rise"?
3. Explain the simile, "'Cause I walk *like I've got oil wells / Pumping in my living room*."
4. What is the central theme of the poem?

ASSIGNMENT

1. Write two paragraphs discussing how Maya Angelou uses **rhetorical questions** and **similes** to create a tone of defiance and empowerment.
2. What makes "Still I Rise" an "anthem"? Explain in your own words.

WEEK 9: NON-AFRICAN POETRY

TOPIC: LORD BYRON – "SHE WALKS IN BEAUTY"

9.1 ABOUT THE POET: LORD BYRON (1788-1824)

George Gordon Byron, known as Lord Byron, was a leading poet of the **British Romantic Movement**. The Romantics valued intense emotion, the beauty of nature, and the inner world of the individual. Byron himself was a famous, passionate, and rebellious figure, and his poetry is known for its lyrical beauty and emotional depth.

9.2 THE POEM: "SHE WALKS IN BEAUTY"

This is a lyrical poem (like a song) that describes the perfect beauty of a woman. The persona is captivated by a woman he saw at a party. The poem's genius is that it does not just describe her physical features; it celebrates the perfect **harmony** between her *outer* beauty (dark hair, starry eyes) and her *inner* beauty (peace, innocence, and goodness).

9.3 CONTENT ANALYSIS

- **Stanza 1:** The poem opens with its famous simile: "She walks in beauty, *like the night / Of cloudless climes and starry skies*." Her beauty is not the "gaudy" (bright, harsh) light of day; it is the deep, clear, and profound beauty of a perfect night. Her beauty is a "tender light" made from the perfect "meet" (meeting) of "all that's best of dark and bright."
- **Stanza 2:** Her beauty is a perfect balance. "One shade the more, one ray the less" would "half impair" (damage) her "nameless grace." He then connects this outer beauty to her inner world. Her "raven tress" (black hair) and her face "serenely sweet" *express* the "thoughts" within her, showing how "pure" and "dear" her mind is.
- **Stanza 3:** He continues this link between inner and outer beauty. Her "cheek," "brow," and "smiles that win" are all reflections of her inner goodness. They "tell of" (reveal) a life spent in "goodness," a "mind at peace with all below," and a "heart whose love is innocent!"

9.4 THEMES

1. **The Perfection of Beauty:** The poem is a celebration of a woman's perfect, flawless beauty.
2. **The Harmony of Inner and Outer Beauty:** This is the central theme. The persona is not just struck by her pretty face; he is struck by how her physical beauty is a *direct expression* of her inner purity, innocence, and peace.
3. **The Power of Innocence and Purity:** The poem ends by celebrating her "innocent" heart as the source of her "calm" brow and "winning" smile.

9.5 DICTION, MOOD, AND IMAGERY

- **Diction (Word Choice):** The language is elevated, graceful, and soft. Words like "serenely," "sweet," "eloquent," "peace," "calm," and "innocent" create a feeling of purity.
- **Mood:** The mood is one of **admiration, awe, reverence, and tranquility**.
- **Poetic Devices:**
 1. **Simile:** "She walks in beauty, *like the night*..." (The central device of the poem).
 2. **Juxtaposition (Contrast):** The entire poem is built on the perfect balance of opposites:
 - "dark and bright"
 - "gaudy day" vs. "starry skies"
 3. **Personification:** Her face and smile "tell of" her goodness; they are "eloquent."
 4. **Alliteration & Assonance:** These musical devices make the poem flow beautifully:
 - "cloudless climes"
 - "serenely sweet"
 - "day denies"

EVALUATION

1. What is the central simile used in the poem?
2. Why does the poet compare the woman's beauty to "night" instead of "day"?
3. What is the relationship between the woman's inner beauty and outer beauty?

4. Describe the mood of the poem.

ASSIGNMENT

1. Write a detailed analysis of the first stanza of "She Walks in Beauty."
2. Discuss the theme "The Harmony of Inner and Outer Beauty," using evidence from the poem.



WEEK 10: NON-AFRICAN POETRY (COMPARATIVE STUDY)

TOPIC 1: SEAMUS HEANEY – "DIGGING"

10.1 ABOUT THE POET: SEAMUS HEANEY (1939-2013)

Seamus Heaney was an Irish poet who won the Nobel Prize in Literature in 1995. His work is deeply rooted in the rural Irish landscape, his family, and the past. He is celebrated for his "earthy" language and his ability to find profound meaning in common, everyday objects and actions.

10.2 CONTENT, STRUCTURE, AND TONE

- **Content:** The poem begins in the present: the persona is a writer, sitting at his desk with his "snug" pen. He hears his father "digging" in the garden, which triggers a memory. He remembers his father digging for potatoes 20 years earlier, and then a deeper memory of his *grandfather* digging for turf (peat). He admires their skill and strength, "nicking and slicing." He realizes *he* has no spade to follow them. The poem ends with a powerful resolution: he will use his *pen* as his tool. He will "dig" with his pen, excavating his roots, family history, and memories.
- **Structure:** The poem moves through time: **Present** (Persona with pen) → **Immediate Past** (Father) → **Distant Past** (Grandfather) → **Present** (Persona with pen). This structure shows him digging *metaphorically* into his own past.
- **Tone:** The tone is **reflective, admiring** (of his father and grandfather), and finally, **resolute** (determined).

10.3 POETIC ANALYSIS

1. **Central Metaphor: The pen is the poet's spade.** "Between my finger and my thumb / The squat pen rests. / I'll dig with it."
2. **Imagery:** The poem is famous for its rich, "earthy" sensory imagery.
 - **Aural (Sound):** "the clean rasping *sound*," "the squelch and slap."
 - **Visual:** "stooping in rhythm," "Nicking and slicing."

- **Olfactory (Smell):** "the cold smell of potato mould."
- 3. **Onomatopoeia:** Words that imitate sounds: "rasping," "squelch," "slap."
- 4. **Theme:** The central theme is the relationship between **family heritage, manual labour, and the craft of writing**. The poet finds a way to honour his family's tradition of "digging" by adopting it metaphorically for his own vocation as a writer.

TOPIC 2: FLEUR ADCOCK – "THE TELEPHONE CALL"

10.4 ABOUT THE POET: FLEUR ADCOCK (B. 1934)

Fleur Adcock is a New Zealand poet who spent most of her life in England. Her poetry is often characterized by its witty, conversational, and ironic tone, and it frequently observes the strange or absurd parts of modern life.



SS2 LITERATURE-IN-ENGLISH

SECOND TERM LESSON NOTES

WEEK 1: WELCOME TEST AND REVIEW OF PROSE

1.1 WELCOME TEST & REVIEW OF FIRST TERM'S WORK

- (This period would typically be used for a short assessment on the African and Non-African poetry covered in the First Term.)
- **Brief Review:** Recall the literary analysis from the First Term. We learned to identify **themes** (the central messages, like in "Once Upon a Time" or "Still I Rise") and **poetic devices** (the tools, like metaphors, similes, and tone). We will use these same analytical skills, but this term we will apply them to **Prose**.

1.2 INTRODUCTION TO PROSE

Prose is written language in its ordinary form, without the metrical (rhythmic) structure of poetry. It is the language of everyday speech, of textbooks, novels, short stories, and articles. Unlike poetry, which uses lines and stanzas, prose is structured using **sentences** and **paragraphs**.

1.3 KEY ELEMENTS OF PROSE (LITERARY TERMS)

To analyse prose, we must understand its fundamental building blocks.

1. **PLOT:** This is the *sequence of events* that make up a story. It is the "what happens." The plot is deliberately arranged by the author to create suspense, interest, and emotional response. The typical structure is **Freytag's Pyramid**:
 - **Exposition:** The beginning. Introduces the characters, setting, and the basic conflict.
 - **Rising Action:** The series of events and complications that build suspense and lead to the climax.
 - **Climax:** The *turning point* of the story. The moment of highest tension, where the main conflict comes to a head.

- **Falling Action:** The events that happen *after* the climax. The tension decreases, and the "loose ends" begin to be tied up.
- **Resolution (or Dénouement):** The end of the story, where the conflict is resolved and a new "normal" is established.

2. CHARACTER & CHARACTERIZATION:

- **Character:** A person, animal, or entity that takes part in the action of the story.
- **Characterization:** The *method* an author uses to reveal a character's personality.

This can be:

- **Direct:** The author *tells* you (e.g., "He was a kind man.").
- **Indirect:** The author *shows* you through the character's speech, thoughts, actions, appearance, and what others say about them.
- **Types of Characters:**
 - **Protagonist:** The main character, who faces the central conflict.
 - **Antagonist:** The character or force that opposes the protagonist.
 - **Round Character:** Complex, multi-faceted, realistic. You see different sides of their personality.
 - **Flat Character:** Simple, one-dimensional, often a stereotype (e.g., the "wicked stepmother").
 - **Dynamic Character:** A character who *changes* significantly during the story (e.g., in their beliefs or personality).
 - **Static Character:** A character who stays the same from beginning to end.

3. SETTING: The *time* and *place* where the story occurs.

- **Physical Setting:** The geographical location (e.g., a village, a city, a forest, a room).
- **Temporal Setting (Time):** The time period (e.g., 21st century, 1960s, during a war, over the course of one day).
- **Social/Atmospheric Setting:** The social, cultural, and political environment (e.g., a mood of war and fear, a society of strict religious rules, an atmosphere of celebration).

4. **THEME:** The central idea, message, or moral of the story. It is the author's comment on the human condition. A theme is a *universal statement* (e.g., "Love can conquer hate," "Power corrupts," "The past can never be truly escaped").
5. **POINT OF VIEW (NARRATIVE PERSPECTIVE):** *Who* is telling the story.
 - **First-Person:** The narrator is a character in the story (uses "I," "me," "we"). We only know what *this character* knows and feels.
 - **Third-Person Limited:** The narrator is *outside* the story but follows *one* character (uses "he," "she," "they"). We see the story through the eyes and thoughts of that single character.
 - **Third-Person Omniscient ("All-Knowing"):** The narrator is outside the story but can enter the minds of *any* character, knows all past, present, and future events.

EVALUATION

1. In your own words, what is the main difference between prose and poetry?
2. List the five stages of a plot according to Freytag's Pyramid.
3. Explain the difference between a **Dynamic Character** and a **Static Character**.
4. What are the three components of "Setting"?
5. What is the difference between a **First-Person** and **Third-Person Omniscient** narrator?

ASSIGNMENT

1. Pick a simple, well-known story (like a fairy tale or a parable).
2. In one page, analyse it using the terms learned today:
 - Identify the **Protagonist** and **Antagonist**.
 - Describe the **Setting** (physical and social).
 - Briefly outline the **Plot** (Exposition, Climax, Resolution).
 - State its main **Theme**.

WEEK 2: INTRODUCTION TO AFRICAN PROSE

TOPIC: ELMA SHAW – "REDEMPTION ROAD"

2.1 ABOUT THE AUTHOR: ELMA SHAW

Elma Shaw is a Liberian author, journalist, and peace activist. Her work is deeply informed by her experiences during and after the brutal **Liberian Civil Wars** (1989-1997 and 1999-2003). She writes to explore the deep trauma left by the war and to advocate for peace, reconciliation, and social justice, particularly for women and children. *Redemption Road* is her most prominent novel.

2.2 BACKGROUND AND CONTEXT OF "REDEMPTION ROAD"

To understand this novel, you *must* understand its context. The novel is set in **post-war Liberia**, a nation shattered by 14 years of horrific conflict. This was a war infamous for its use of child soldiers, widespread atrocities, and the complete breakdown of society.

When the novel begins, the war is over, but the *trauma* is not. The country is filled with:

- Victims living side-by-side with their former attackers.
- Ex-warlords and combatants who now hold positions of power and wealth.
- A "culture of impunity," where no one has been held accountable for their crimes.
- A generation of young people who have known nothing but violence.
- A deep, collective need for healing, justice, and reconciliation.

Redemption Road is not just a story; it is an exploration of whether a nation—and an individual—can ever truly heal from such deep wounds.

2.3 PLOT STRUCTURE: AN OVERVIEW

Redemption Road is a complex narrative that weaves together the past and the present. It follows the story of **Bendite** (or "Bendet") Kizeku, a successful woman working at the Ministry of

Gender and Development. One day, she accidentally hits a young girl, **Life**, with her car, putting the girl in a coma.

This single event forces Bendite to confront her own "unburied" past and the secrets she has kept from her own family. Her journey to help this girl becomes a "road" to her own redemption. The story unfolds through a main present-day narrative, but it is constantly interrupted by painful **flashbacks** to the war, revealing the dark secrets that connect all the characters.

2.4 SETTING

The setting is a character in itself.

- **1. PHYSICAL SETTING:**

- **Monrovia, Liberia:** The capital city. Shaw presents it as a city of deep contrasts:
 - Government ministries, NGO offices, and the homes of the wealthy.
 - Slums like West Point, where the poor and displaced live.
 - The scarred landscape: burned-out buildings, potholed roads, and other physical reminders of the war.
 - Key locations: The hospital (where Life is), the Ministry, Bendite's comfortable home.

- **2. TEMPORAL SETTING (TIME):**

- **The "Present":** This is post-war Liberia (specifically, around 2005-2007, after the election of Ellen Johnson Sirleaf, Africa's first female president). It is a time of fragile peace and cautious optimism, but also of deep-seated corruption and social problems.
- **The "Past":** The 1990s, during the peak of the civil war. These sections are told through **flashbacks** and are filled with violence, terror, and chaos. The novel argues that this "past" is not over; it is still actively shaping the present.

- **3. SOCIAL AND ATMOSPHERIC SETTING:**

- The atmosphere is one of **collective trauma** and **uneasy peace**.
- There is a deep **distrust** of the government and the justice system, as many ex-warlords have simply "rebranded" themselves as politicians or businessmen.

- There is a tension between the desire for **reconciliation** (moving on) and the cry for **justice** (holding people accountable).
- The novel explores the critical role of women in rebuilding a shattered society.

EVALUATION

1. Who is Elma Shaw, and what major event influences her writing?
2. What is the "culture of impunity" described in the notes?
3. What is the central inciting incident (the event that starts the main plot) of *Redemption Road*?
4. Explain the dual **Temporal Setting** (the two time periods) of the novel.
5. What is the social and atmospheric setting of post-war Monrovia?

ASSIGNMENT

1. Write two paragraphs explaining why it is *impossible* to understand *Redemption Road* without understanding the Liberian Civil War.
2. Define "flashback." Based on the notes, what is the *purpose* of the flashbacks in this novel?

WEEK 3: AFRICAN PROSE

TOPIC: DETAILED ANALYSIS OF "REDEMPTION ROAD" (CHAPTERS 1–5)

(Note: This is a guide to the likely events, characters, and developments in the opening chapters, based on the novel's structure.)

3.1 MAJOR EVENTS (CHAPTERS 1-5)

- **Chapter 1: The Accident.** The novel opens with the protagonist, **Bendite Kizeku**, driving. She is successful, professional, but internally haunted. She is distracted by a memory (a *flashback* is hinted at) and she hits a young girl who ran into the street. The girl is critically injured. This is the **inciting incident**.
- **Chapter 2: The Hospital.** Bendite rushes the girl to a crowded, under-funded hospital. The girl is identified as "Life" and has no family, only a guardian. Bendite is consumed by guilt, which is clearly deeper than just guilt for the accident. We meet Bendite's husband, **Gracious**, who is charming, wealthy, and powerful, but also controlling.
- **Chapter 3: First Flashback.** The narrative plunges into the past. We see a younger Bendite fleeing violence during the war. We learn she had a son, **Tito**, who was abducted and murdered by child soldiers. This is the source of her deep, unresolved trauma.
- **Chapter 4: The Investigation.** We are introduced to **Moses**, a journalist and an old friend of Bendite. He is investigating a story about ex-warlords who are now in government. He is suspicious of Bendite's husband, Gracious. At the hospital, we meet **Ma Musu**, the girl's guardian, who is angry and distrustful of the "rich woman" (Bendite) who hit Life.
- **Chapter 5: Gracious's World.** The perspective shifts slightly to Gracious. We see his power and influence. He assures Bendite he will "take care" of the accident, suggesting a bribe or a cover-up. He is *not* happy about her emotional attachment to the girl. This establishes the central conflicts: Bendite's internal conflict (past vs. present) and the external conflict (Bendite vs. Gracious).

3.2 INTRODUCTION OF CHARACTERS

1. **Bendite Kizeku:** The **protagonist**. She is a **round** and **dynamic** character.
 - *Now:* A successful, educated woman at the Ministry of Gender.
 - *Her Secret:* She is broken by the wartime murder of her son, Tito.
 - *Her Motivation:* Her guilt over the accident with Life is a projection of her guilt and grief for her son. She sees a chance to "save" Life where she failed to save Tito.
2. **Gracious Kizeku:** Bendite's husband. He is the novel's primary **antagonist**.
 - *Publicly:* A wealthy, charismatic, and powerful businessman.
 - *Privately:* Controlling, manipulative, and deeply connected to a dark, violent past. He represents the "impunity" of ex-combatants.
3. **"Life":** The young girl. She is a **symbol**.
 - She represents the new generation of Liberia—an innocent victim, carrying the scars of the past, with an uncertain future.
 - Her name is symbolic: by saving "Life," Bendite is trying to save her own life.
4. **Moses:** The journalist. He is a **catalyst** for the plot.
 - He represents the search for truth and justice.
 - He links Bendite's personal trauma to the larger, national political corruption.
5. **Ma Musu:** Life's guardian. A **flat** character (in these early stages).
 - She represents the "common people"—poor, distrustful of authority, and victims of the system.

EVALUATION

1. Who is the protagonist of the novel, and what is her job?
2. What is the "inciting incident" of the plot?
3. Who is Gracious, and what is our first impression of him?
4. What is the great trauma of Bendite's past that is revealed in a flashback?
5. What symbolic role does the character "Life" play?

ASSIGNMENT

1. Based on the first five chapters, write a **character analysis** of Bendite Kizeku. (Two paragraphs).
2. Explain the different types of **conflict** being set up in the novel (e.g., internal: Bendite vs. her past; external: Bendite vs. Gracious).



WEEK 4: AFRICAN PROSE

TOPIC: "REDEMPTION ROAD" (CHAPTERS 6–10)

4.1 CONTINUED PLOT ANALYSIS (CHAPTERS 6-10)

This section of the novel is the **Rising Action**. The conflicts get more complicated, and the past begins to collide more violently with the present.

- **Events:** Life remains in a coma. Bendite's visits become an obsession. She neglects her job and her husband to sit by the girl's bedside.
- **Moses's Investigation:** Moses discovers a direct link between Gracious and a notorious wartime general known as "General Cobra," who was responsible for the massacre in Bendite's hometown.
- **The Shocking Revelation:** Moses finds an old photo. He realizes the truth: **Gracious is General Cobra**. Gracious, the charming husband, is the same man who commanded the forces that abducted and killed Bendite's son, Tito.
- **Bendite's Suspicion:** Bendite finds old papers in Gracious's office that he told her were "business," but they contain lists of ex-combatants' names. She also recognizes a man visiting their house as a feared figure from the war. Her "perfect" life begins to crack.
- **Ma Musu's Story:** Bendite and Ma Musu finally have a real conversation. Ma Musu tells her *Life's* story: the girl's parents were killed in the war, and she has been silent ever since, only recently beginning to speak. This strengthens Bendite's bond with the child.

4.2 THEMES

1. **The Unburied Past:** This theme is now central. The novel shows that the past is not "past"—it is alive and toxic. Gracious's secret identity *is* the unburied past.
2. **Guilt and Atonement:** Bendite's guilt is the driving force. She feels she must atone for her son's death. The novel asks: Can one "atone" for a crime if the *real* criminal is sleeping next to you?
3. **Appearance vs. Reality:** This is a major theme.

- *Appearance*: Gracious is a loving husband, a successful businessman, a "redeemed" member of society.
 - *Reality*: He is a war criminal, a murderer, and a monster.
 - *Appearance*: Bendite is a strong, successful "new Liberian" woman.
 - *Reality*: She is a broken, grieving mother, trapped in a lie.
4. **Corruption and Impunity**: The fact that a man like "General Cobra" can become "Gracious Kizeku" and hold power is a direct critique of post-war Liberia. It shows how "blood money" has been washed clean, and justice has been denied.

4.3 CHARACTER DEVELOPMENT

- **Bendite Kizeku**: She begins her **dynamic** shift. Her obsession with Life is still a projection, but her new *suspicion* of Gracious is the beginning of her journey to the *truth*. She is moving from a passive state of grief to an active, if terrifying, investigation.
- **Gracious Kizeku**: His **antagonist** role is cemented. He becomes more controlling, subtly threatening Moses and warning Bendite to stop visiting the hospital. His "charming" mask is slipping, revealing the "Cobra" underneath.
- **Moses**: His role as **catalyst** and **truth-seeker** is now critical. He holds the key to the entire plot. He faces a moral dilemma: does he publish the story and potentially destroy his friend, Bendite, or does he hide the truth?

EVALUATION

1. What is the "Rising Action" in a plot?
2. What is the shocking truth Moses discovers about Gracious?
3. Explain the theme of "Appearance vs. Reality" using Gracious as an example.
4. How is Bendite's character developing in this section?
5. What is the central "unburied past" that the novel is digging up?

ASSIGNMENT

1. Write two paragraphs on the theme of **Corruption and Impunity** in *Redemption Road*.

2. Imagine you are Moses. What would you do with the information that Gracious is General Cobra? Write a short (1-paragraph) journal entry explaining your dilemma.



WEEK 5: MIDTERM EXAMINATION

(This week is for the assessment of all topics covered in Weeks 1-4. No new lesson notes.)



WEEK 6: AFRICAN PROSE

TOPIC: "REDEMPTION ROAD" (CHAPTERS 11–15, CLIMAX & RESOLUTION)

6.1 PLOT ANALYSIS (CHAPTERS 11-15)

This section contains the **Climax** and **Resolution** of the novel.

- **Chapter 11: The Confrontation (Climax).** Moses, fearing for Bendite's safety, gives her his evidence (photos, documents). Bendite confronts Gracious.
- **Chapter 12: Gracious's Confession.** The mask finally comes off. Gracious (as General Cobra) confesses. He is not sorry; he is *proud* of his actions. He justifies them as "survival" and "power." He admits he knew *exactly* who she was when he married her. He saw her as a "trophy," a way to launder his past and buy respectability. He reveals he *personally* gave the order that led to her son's death.
- **Chapter 13: Bendite's Choice.** This is Bendite's true moment of redemption. She has to choose between her comfortable, false life and the terrible, liberating truth. She escapes the house and takes the evidence to the authorities (or an international tribunal). Gracious is arrested, or perhaps he flees the country.
- **Chapter 14: The Hospital (Falling Action).** Bendite goes to the hospital. The news is full of her husband's exposure. She sits by Life's bed, exhausted but free. She confesses her *own* story to the comatose girl. As she speaks, Life wakes up.
- **Chapter 15: The Resolution.** The ending is not perfectly "happy," but it is *hopeful*. Life's recovery is symbolic of the nation's. Bendite, having faced her past and chosen justice over comfort, is finally free from her grief. She has found her "redemption" not by *saving* Life, but by *telling the truth*. The novel ends with Bendite and Life starting a new, honest life, walking down a new "road."

6.2 STYLISTIC AND STRUCTURAL ANALYSIS

1. Narrative Structure: Dual Timeline & Flashbacks

- **Structure:** The novel is built on the constant *interruption* of the present by the past.

- **Effect:** This is the most important stylistic choice. It shows that for survivors of trauma, the past is not a separate, distant time. It is a *present, active wound*. The flashbacks are not just "backstory"; they are the *cause* of all present-day events.
- **Example:** Bendite's distraction leading to the accident is *caused* by a flashback. The past literally *crashes* into the present.

2. Point of View (POV): Third-Person

- The novel uses a **Third-Person narrative**, but the *focus* shifts.
- It is primarily **Third-Person Limited** to Bendite. We feel her guilt, her suspicion, her terror.
- However, the author *also* gives us access to Moses's thoughts (to advance the plot) and occasionally Gracious's (to show his malice). This makes the POV closer to **Third-Person Omniscient** at times, allowing the author to weave a complete social and political tapestry.

3. Symbolism:

- **"Redemption Road":** The title itself. It is the literal road of the accident, but also the metaphorical journey from guilt to truth, from trauma to healing.
- **"Life":** The girl is a symbol of the innocent, brutalized, and resilient future of Liberia.
- **"Gracious":** His name is a bitter **irony**. He is the opposite of "gracious."
- **The Accident:** The "collision" of the past and present, the rich and the poor, the guilty and the innocent.

EVALUATION

1. What is the **Climax** of the novel?
2. What is the **Resolution**? Is it a "happy" ending? Explain.
3. Explain the *effect* of the **dual timeline** and **flashback** structure. Why did the author choose this?
4. What is the major **irony** associated with the character Gracious?
5. What does the title "Redemption Road" symbolize?

ASSIGNMENT

1. Write a final, comprehensive **character analysis of Bendite Kizeku**, explaining how she is a **dynamic character** from Chapter 1 to Chapter 15.
2. In two paragraphs, discuss the novel's main **theme**: "There can be no true reconciliation without justice."



WEEK 7: MIDTERM BREAK

(This week is a break. No new lesson notes.)



WEEK 8: NON-AFRICAN PROSE

TOPIC: SUSANNE BELLEFEUILLE – "PATH OF LUCAS: THE JOURNEY HE ENDURED"

8.1 ABOUT THE AUTHOR: SUSANNE BELLEFEUILLE

Susanne Bellefeuille is a contemporary Canadian author. She writes primarily in the **Young Adult (YA)** and **New Adult** genres, focusing on stories of emotional resilience, romance, and recovery. Her works are known for their deep emotional honesty and their focus on the internal, psychological journeys of their characters.

8.2 BACKGROUND OF THE TEXT: "PATH OF LUCAS"

Unlike *Redemption Road*, which deals with *national* and *collective* trauma, *Path of Lucas* is a story of *individual* and *personal* trauma. It is a contemporary Young Adult novel.

- **Genre:** Young Adult (YA) Contemporary / Romance.
- **Focus:** The story is not about war or politics, but about the deeply personal journey of one young man.
- **Context:** It is set in a peaceful, modern, First World society (Canada). This is important because the "problems" are not systemic oppression, but personal tragedy and the psychological struggle to overcome it.

8.3 TEXT OVERVIEW (PLOT SUMMARY)

Path of Lucas is the story of **Lucas**, a young man (often a star athlete in this genre) whose life is perfect until a single, tragic event—such as a devastating car accident or a sports injury—changes everything.

The "path" of the title is his journey of **endurance**. He must endure the loss of his old life (his ability to walk, his sport, his popular status) and navigate a new, difficult reality. The novel charts his psychological journey from deep depression, anger, and denial to a slow, painful acceptance. A key part of this journey is his relationship with **Sarah**, a woman who enters his

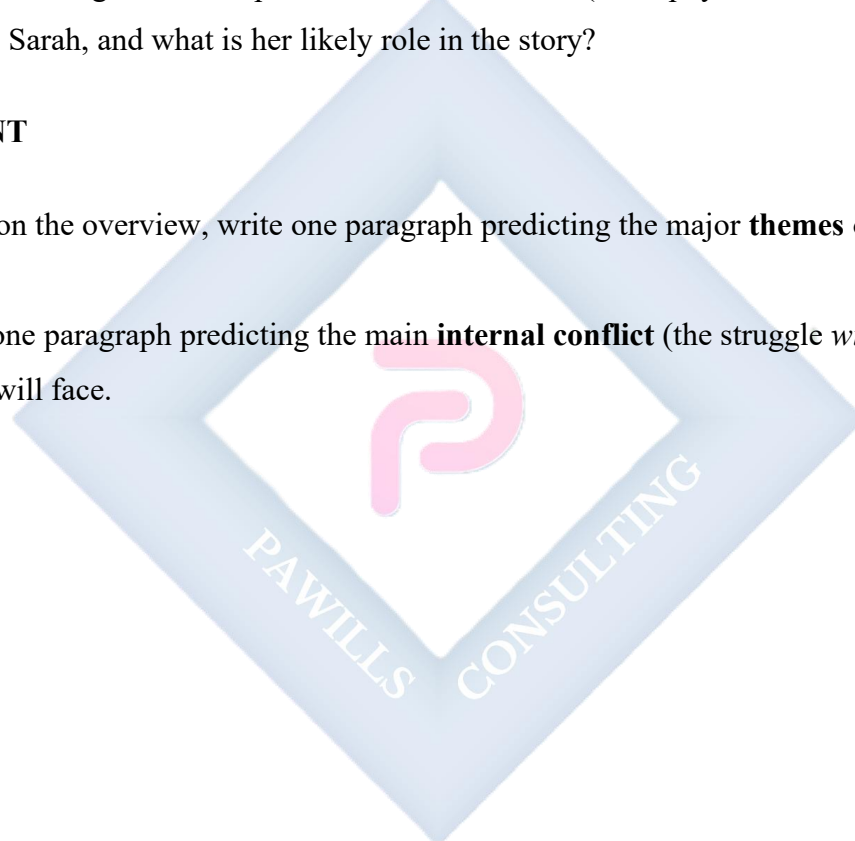
life *after* the tragedy and who must help him see that he is more than just his "broken" body. The story is a testament to the power of love and the resilience of the human spirit.

EVALUATION

1. Who is Susanne Bellefeuille, and what genre does she write?
2. What is the major difference in *context* between *Redemption Road* and *Path of Lucas*?
3. What is the "tragedy" that sets the plot of *Path of Lucas* in motion?
4. What two things does the "path" in the title refer to? (Hint: physical and...?)
5. Who is Sarah, and what is her likely role in the story?

ASSIGNMENT

1. Based on the overview, write one paragraph predicting the major **themes** of *Path of Lucas*.
2. Write one paragraph predicting the main **internal conflict** (the struggle *within*) that Lucas will face.



WEEK 9: NON-AFRICAN PROSE

TOPIC: "PATH OF LUCAS" (CHAPTERS 1–6)

9.1 DETAILED ANALYSIS (CHAPTERS 1-6, LIKELY EVENTS)

This section covers the **Exposition** and the **Inciting Incident**.

- **Chapters 1-2 (Exposition):** We meet **Lucas**. He is at the peak of his life: a popular, charismatic star hockey player, destined for a professional scholarship. He has a beautiful, popular girlfriend, **Jessica**. His life is defined by his physical strength and his status as an athlete. The tone is bright, energetic, and confident.
- **Chapter 3 (Inciting Incident):** The tragedy. During a key championship game, Lucas is checked hard from behind, flying head-first into the boards (the wall). There is a *crack*. He feels nothing. He cannot move his legs. The bright, loud arena goes silent.
- **Chapters 4-5 (The Verdict):** The hospital. The chapters are a blur of doctors, tests, and his terrified parents. The verdict is delivered: a severe spinal cord injury. He is paralyzed from the waist down. He will never walk, let alone play hockey, again.
- **Chapter 6 (The New Reality):** Lucas is in the rehabilitation centre. His denial has shattered, leaving only a "black hole" of rage and depression. He lashes out at everyone: his parents, his friends, and especially his girlfriend, Jessica, who is visibly uncomfortable and doesn't know how to talk to him. He is no longer "Star Lucas"; he is "Lucas in a wheelchair," and he hates himself.

9.2 MAJOR THEMES (EMERGING)

1. **PERSEVERANCE AND ENDURANCE:** This is the central theme, stated in the title. The novel will be a test of *how* he endures this. Right now, he is *failing* to endure.
2. **LOSS OF IDENTITY:** This is the core conflict. Lucas's *entire* identity was tied to his body and his sport. Now that is gone, he believes he is *nothing*. The journey will be about discovering that his "self" is not his "legs."
3. **LOVE (AND ITS LIMITS):**

- **Superficial Love:** His relationship with Jessica is exposed as superficial. It was based on their shared status. She loved "Star Lucas," but she is afraid of "Disabled Lucas."
 - **Familial Love:** His parents' love is unconditional, but he pushes them away.
4. **COPING WITH TRAGEDY:** The novel is a raw look at the psychological stages of grief (denial, anger, depression, bargaining, acceptance). Lucas is deep in the "anger" and "depression" stages.

EVALUATION

1. What was Lucas's life like *before* the inciting incident?
2. What is the inciting incident in this novel?
3. What is Lucas's psychological state in Chapters 4-6?
4. Explain the theme of "Loss of Identity" as it relates to Lucas.
5. What does the character of Jessica represent?

ASSIGNMENT

1. Write a **first-person journal entry** (one paragraph) from Lucas's point of view, as he lies in the hospital (Chapter 5). Express his anger, fear, and despair.
2. Write a **first-person journal entry** (one paragraph) from Jessica's point of view, after visiting Lucas (Chapter 6). Express her confusion, fear, and guilt.

WEEK 10: NON-AFRICAN PROSE

TOPIC: "PATH OF LUCAS" (CHARACTERIZATION, PLOT DEV., NARRATIVE TECHNIQUES)

10.1 PLOT DEVELOPMENT (THE REST OF THE NOVEL)

This covers the **Rising Action**, **Climax**, and **Resolution**.

- **Rising Action:**

- Lucas goes home, but his house is a prison of obstacles.
- He meets **Sarah**, his new, blunt, and tough-as-nails physical therapist. He hates her because she won't tolerate his self-pity.
- **The Break-up:** Jessica officially breaks up with him, confirming his worst fears: that he is "unlovable."
- **The Struggle:** The gruelling, painful, and often humiliating process of physiotherapy. Sarah pushes him, and they fight constantly.
- **The Shift:** He has a breakthrough. He sees Sarah not as a tormentor, but as someone who respects him *too* much to let him quit. A new, deeper connection (love) begins to form, but he feels he is "not good enough" for her.

- **Climax:**

- Lucas faces a major test. He is invited by a local wheelchair rugby team to try out. He is terrified. He goes, and he is clumsy, slow, and gets knocked over. He is about to quit in anger...
- ...but he *gets back up*. He sees Sarah watching. He gets back in the game. He's not a "star," but he is *part* of a team. He has found a new way to "play." This is his moment of **acceptance**. He has found a new identity.

- **Falling Action:**

- He joins the team. He starts coaching kids.
- His relationship with Sarah becomes romantic. It is a mature love, based on emotional honesty, not on superficial status.

- **Resolution:**

- Lucas is on his "path." He is still in a wheelchair, but he is no longer *defined* by it. He has **endured** the journey and found a new, stronger version of himself. He has found a new purpose and a new love.

10.2 CHARACTERIZATION

- **Lucas:** The **protagonist**. A classic **dynamic character**. He transforms from an arrogant (then self-pitying) boy into a mature, empathetic, and resilient man.
- **Sarah:** The **catalyst** for Lucas's change. She represents **tough love**. She is not gentle; she forces him to confront his own self-hatred. She is a **round character**, with her own backstory of loss that allows her to connect with Lucas.
- **Jessica:** The **foil** to Sarah. She is a **flat** and **static** character. She represents the superficiality of Lucas's old life. Her inability to cope highlights the strength of Sarah's love.

10.3 NARRATIVE TECHNIQUES

1. Point of View: First-Person ("I")

- The *entire* novel is told from **Lucas's point of view**.
- **Effect:** This is crucial. It creates **immediacy** and **empathy**. We are trapped *inside Lucas's head*. We feel his rage, his despair, his pain, and his small victories. The reader is forced to "endure" the journey *with* him.

2. Tone:

- The tone **mirrors Lucas's journey**. It begins as *energetic*, shifts to *bitter, cynical, and depressive*, and slowly, painfully transforms into one of *struggle, hope*, and finally, *acceptance*.

3. Flashbacks:

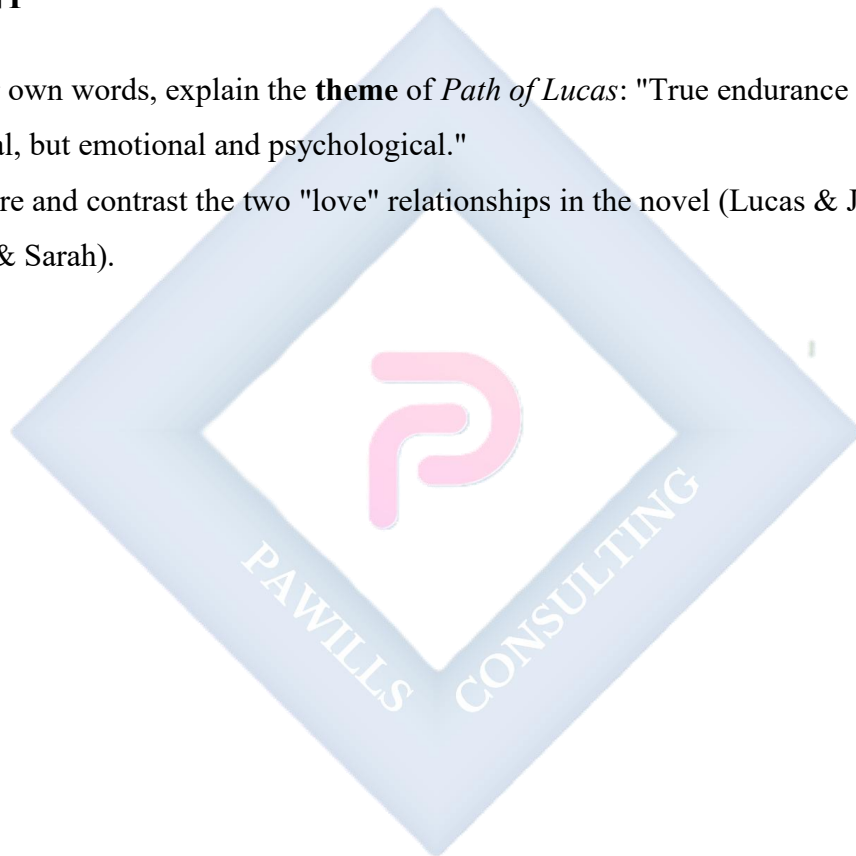
- The novel uses frequent, painful flashbacks.
- **Use:** Lucas is haunted by memories of his "old self" (running, scoring, dancing with Jessica).
- **Effect:** These flashbacks *contrast* sharply with his present reality, emphasizing the 'Loss of Identity' theme and showing the reader exactly what he has lost.

EVALUATION

1. Describe the **Climax** of the novel. What does Lucas *accept* in this moment?
2. Explain how Lucas is a **dynamic character**.
3. What is the purpose of the character Jessica (a "foil")?
4. What is the **narrative point of view**, and what is its effect on the reader?
5. How does the **tone** of the novel change from beginning to end?

ASSIGNMENT

1. In your own words, explain the **theme** of *Path of Lucas*: "True endurance is not just physical, but emotional and psychological."
2. Compare and contrast the two "love" relationships in the novel (Lucas & Jessica vs. Lucas & Sarah).



WEEK 11: REVISION

TOPIC: GENERAL REVIEW OF "REDEMPTION ROAD" AND "PATH OF LUCAS"

This week is dedicated to reviewing both prose texts in preparation for the examination. The best way to revise is to **compare and contrast** them.

COMPARATIVE ANALYSIS

Feature	"Redemption Road" (Elma Shaw)	"Path of Lucas" (Susanne Bellefeuille)
Genre	Post-Colonial Literature; Political Fiction	Young Adult (YA) Contemporary; Romance
Setting	Post-war Liberia (Africa). A real, politically unstable, and traumatized nation.	Modern-day Canada (Non-Africa). A peaceful, stable, and wealthy nation.
Protagonist	Bendite Kizeku. A middle-aged woman.	Lucas. A young adult man.
Central Conflict	Man vs. Society / Man vs. The Past. Bendite must expose the corruption and impunity of a warlord (Gracious) to free herself and her society from the trauma of the civil war.	Man vs. Self. Lucas must overcome his own depression, anger, and self-hatred to accept his disability and find a new identity.
Key Symbol	"Redemption Road." A metaphorical journey for a <i>nation</i> and an individual.	"Path of Lucas." A metaphorical journey for an <i>individual</i> .
Central Trauma	Collective Trauma: Civil war, child soldiers, massacres.	Individual Trauma: A personal accident, disability.
Antagonist	Gracious ("General Cobra"). An external, human villain who represents a corrupt system.	Lucas's own despair. An internal, psychological antagonist.
Narrative POV	Third-Person (Omniscient/Limited). Focuses on Bendite, but shows other views	First-Person. Traps the reader inside Lucas's head to maximize

	(Moses) to build a social picture.	emotional empathy.
Core Themes	Justice vs. Reconciliation, Impunity, The Unburied Past, National Healing.	Perseverance, Loss of Identity, Enduring Love, Individual Recovery.

REVISION ASSIGNMENT

1. **Comparative Essay (Prompt):** "Both *Redemption Road* and *Path of Lucas* are about journeys of 'endurance' and 'healing.' Compare and contrast the **nature of the central conflict** and the **type of trauma** explored in each novel. How does the **setting** of each book (one African, one Non-African) influence the story?"
2. **Short Answer Questions:**
 - o a. How is the theme of "The Past" different in *Redemption Road* vs. *Path of Lucas*?
 - o b. Compare the role of the antagonist (Gracious) with the "antagonist" in *Path of Lucas*.
 - o c. Which narrative style (Third-Person vs. First-Person) did you find more effective, and why?

SS2 LITERATURE-IN-ENGLISH LESSON NOTES

THIRD TERM

WEEK 1: INTRODUCTION TO AFRICAN DRAMA

1.1 OVERVIEW OF DRAMA

Drama is a genre of literature that is written to be performed on a stage by actors. It is a composite art form, meaning it blends several arts: literature (the script), performance (acting), visual art (scenery, costumes), and often music and dance. Unlike prose, which is *told* by a narrator, or poetry, which is *expressed*, drama is *shown* to an audience through dialogue and action.

1.2 DEFINING AFRICAN DRAMA

African Drama is drama produced by African playwrights, which reflects the African worldview, culture, and experience. It is not simply drama *set* in Africa; it is drama that is *from* an African perspective. It emerged as a major literary force in the mid-20th century, particularly during the struggle for independence, as a way to reclaim African stories and cultural identity from colonial narratives.

1.3 CULTURAL INFLUENCES ON AFRICAN DRAMA

What makes African Drama unique is its deep root in traditional African forms of art and expression.

1. **ORAL TRADITION:** This is the most important influence.

- **Storytelling:** The structure of many plays is based on a storyteller (or *griot*) addressing an audience. The plot is often episodic, like a folktale.
- **Proverbs & Aphorisms:** Dialogue is rich with traditional wisdom, proverbs, and riddles. Language is used not just for communication, but as a sign of wisdom.
- **Folktales:** Many plays are adaptations of folktales, especially those involving trickster figures (like Ananse the spider or the Tortoise) or spiritual themes.

2. FESTIVALS AND RITUALS:

- Traditional festivals were a form of "total theatre." They combined ritual, masquerades, music, storytelling, and audience participation.
- African playwrights (like Wole Soyinka and J.P. Clark) borrowed this "total theatre" concept. Their plays are often non-realistic and ceremonial.
- **Masquerades (Mmanwu):** The masquerade, a figure that is both human and spirit, is a common dramatic device, representing the link between the living, the dead, and the unborn.

3. MUSIC, SONG, AND DANCE:

- In traditional African drama, song and dance are *not* interruptions (like in a Western musical). They are essential parts of the narrative.
- Songs are used to set the mood, provide background information (like a chorus), or express a character's inner feelings. Dance is a form of language.

4. AUDIENCE PARTICIPATION:

- In traditional performances, the line between performers and the audience was thin. The audience was expected to respond, sing along, and participate.
- African drama often tries to recreate this, "breaking the fourth wall" and involving the audience directly.

5. COMMON THEMES:

- **Clash of Cultures:** Tradition vs. Modernity; African values vs. European/Colonial values.
- **Social & Political Critique:** Satire of post-independence corruption, dictatorship, and social ills.
- **History & Myth:** Re-telling history from an African perspective and exploring the relationship between humans and the gods.

EVALUATION

1. What is a "composite art form," and why is drama a good example?
2. What is the single most important cultural influence on African Drama?
3. Explain the concept of "total theatre" as it relates to traditional festivals.
4. What is the role of song and dance in African Drama?

5. List three common themes found in African Drama.

ASSIGNMENT

1. Write two paragraphs explaining the difference between a Western (e.g., European) play you might know and the *characteristics* of African Drama as described in the notes.
2. Research the meaning of the term "griot" and write a short description of their role in society.



WEEK 2: AFRICAN DRAMA

TOPIC: EFUA SUTHERLAND – "THE MARRIAGE OF ANANSEWA"

2.1 ABOUT THE PLAYWRIGHT: EFUA SUTHERLAND (1924-1996)

Efua Sutherland was a highly influential Ghanaian playwright, poet, and cultural activist. She is considered one of the "mothers" of modern African drama. She founded the Ghana Drama Studio, which became a model for creative development across the continent. Her work was dedicated to blending traditional Ghanaian performance forms with modern theatrical techniques.

2.2 BACKGROUND OF THE PLAY

The play is Sutherland's brilliant experiment in creating a modern play using the blueprint of a traditional Akan (Ghanaian) oral tradition called **Anansesem**.

What is *Anansesem*?

- "Anansesem" simply means "Ananse story" or "spider story."
- It is a traditional storytelling session built around the most famous African trickster figure, **Ananse** (the spider).
- **Key Features of *Anansesem*:**
 1. **The Storyteller:** The performance is led by a master storyteller.
 2. **Audience Participation:** The audience is active, responding to the storyteller.
 3. **Mmomome:** Short, "pure-cast" songs that are sung by the audience at key moments to comment on the action or transition between scenes.
 4. **The Trickster:** The hero, Ananse, is not a moral, strong hero. He is a *trickster*—small, weak, greedy, and lazy, but he *always* wins by using his intelligence (cunning) to outsmart stronger opponents.

Sutherland's goal was to put this traditional, oral, interactive art form *onto a modern stage*.

2.3 SETTING

- **Physical Setting:** The play is set in a "room" in modern-day Ghana. However, this room is not realistic; it's a "stage." The most important part of the set is the "Property Man," who wordlessly gives Ananse every prop he needs (like a typewriter, a camera), showing that we are in a *storytelling* world, not a real one.
- **Temporal/Atmospheric Setting:** It is set in "modern" times, where poverty is a real problem. We see a clash of old and new: Ananse uses a *typewriter* and *photographs* to conduct his old-fashioned marriage scam.

2.4 SUMMARY OF ACT ONE

- **The Storyteller:** The play begins with the Storyteller, who directly addresses the audience and "sets the stage," telling us we are here for an *Anansem*.
- **Ananse's Problem:** We meet **Kweku Ananse**, the father, and his daughter, **Anansewa**. They are very poor. Ananse is frustrated with his "ragged-clothed poverty."
- **The "Get-Rich-Quick" Scheme:** Ananse decides to solve his money problem. He will "market" his beautiful, educated daughter (Anansewa) for marriage. But his plan is a trick. He won't just find *one* husband.
- **The Plan in Action:** Ananse writes letters to four different wealthy chiefs, all at the same time, without telling them about each other. He cleverly includes a photograph of Anansewa with each letter. His goal is to get all four of them to send him "head-money" and gifts (dowry payments).
- **Anansewa's Role:** Anansewa, who is studying to be a secretary, is a willing participant. She types the letters for her father and seems excited by the game, though a little uneasy.
- **The First Returns:** The plan works *too* well. Messengers and gifts (money, drinks, cloth) begin to arrive from the various chiefs (Togbe 'Vivi' of Vui, Chief Sapa of Sapa, and the powerful Chief-who-is-Chief).
- **Ananse's Joy:** The Act ends with Ananse celebrating his newfound wealth and his own cleverness. He has successfully tricked them all.

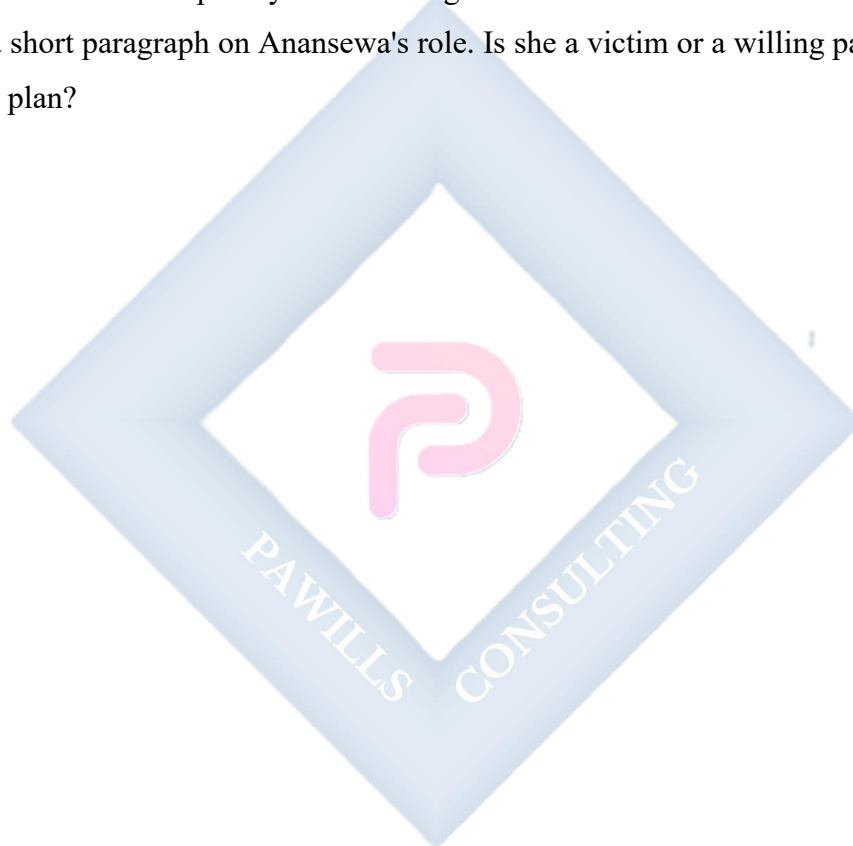
EVALUATION

1. Who was Efua Sutherland?

2. What is *Anansesem*? List three key features of this tradition.
3. Who is the *protagonist* of *Anansesem*, and what is his primary characteristic?
4. What is Ananse's "get-rich-quick" scheme in Act One?
5. What role do *modern* items (like a typewriter) play in Ananse's traditional scam?

ASSIGNMENT

1. In your own words, describe the character of Ananse as seen in Act One. Is he a "good" or "bad" character? Explain your reasoning.
2. Write a short paragraph on Anansewa's role. Is she a victim or a willing participant in her father's plan?



WEEK 3: AFRICAN DRAMA

TOPIC: "THE MARRIAGE OF ANANSEWA" (ACTS TWO–THREE)

3.1 PLOT SUMMARY: ACT TWO

- **The Problem:** Ananse's plan has worked too well. The gifts are pouring in. He has even acquired a "fashionable lady," **Miss Christina (Christie)**, with his new money.
- **The Crisis:** A crisis hits. He receives messages that *all* the chiefs are so impressed that they are *on their way* to claim Anansewa as their bride. The chiefs are coming to the "outdooing" ceremony for Anansewa.
- **Ananse's Trap:** Ananse is trapped. If the chiefs meet and discover his scam, they will be furious. He will be disgraced, and they might take their gifts back.
- **The New Plan: The "Fake Death":** Ananse, the master trickster, devises a new, more drastic plan. To get out of the "marriage," Anansewa must **die**.
- **Convincing Anansewa:** He explains the plan to a shocked Anansewa. She must pretend to be dead. This is the only way to "gracefully" end the marriage contracts without getting in trouble.
- **The "Death":** Anansewa reluctantly agrees. She lies down on the "funeral bed." Ananse and Christie begin to wail and mourn, starting the "funeral."

3.2 PLOT SUMMARY: ACT THREE

- **The Funeral:** This act takes place entirely at Anansewa's "funeral." Ananse has gathered all the neighbours and mourners.
- **The Messengers Arrive:** One by one, messengers from the four chiefs arrive. They are shocked to hear of Anansewa's "death."
- **The "Test" of the Chiefs:** The funeral now becomes a *test*. Ananse, as the grieving father, listens as each messenger gives a speech. Their speeches and the "funeral donations" they give reveal the *true character* of their masters.
 - Some chiefs send mean, insulting messages (e.g., they want their money back).

- **Chief-who-is-Chief**, however, sends a moving message of grief. He says that even in death, Anansewa is his "wife." He sends lavish gifts, pledges to pay for the *entire* funeral, and promises to support Ananse for the rest of his life.
- **Ananse's Choice:** Ananse, in his "grief," publicly shames the other chiefs. He formally declares that **Chief-who-is-Chief** is the *only* one who was worthy of his daughter. He proclaims him the *sole, true husband*.
- **The "Miracle":** Having secured the richest and most honourable chief, Ananse now needs to end the "death." He performs a "ritual." Anansewa "miraculously" wakes up! The mourners are overjoyed.
- **The Ending:** Ananse has won. He has successfully filtered out the bad suitors, identified the best one, and secured a rich, powerful son-in-law. The Storyteller ends the play, celebrating Ananse's cunning.

3.3 CHARACTERIZATION

1. **KWEKU ANANSE:** The **protagonist** and **trickster**. He is greedy, manipulative, selfish, and uses his daughter as "bait." However, he is also charismatic, highly intelligent, witty, and resourceful. We (the audience) are encouraged to admire his cleverness, even if we dislike his morals.
2. **ANANSEWA:** The daughter. She is **not** a passive victim. She is educated (can type) and is a **complicit** (willing) partner in the Act One scam. Her "death" in Act Two shows her obedience, but the entire plot depends on her intelligence to "play dead" convincingly. She is the pawn, but a clever one.
3. **STORYTELLER:** The play's narrator and guide. He is the link to the *Anansem* tradition. He "breaks the fourth wall" by speaking directly to the audience.
4. **MISS CHRISTINA (CHRISTIE):** Ananse's "bit-on-the-side." She is shallow, materialistic, and fashionable. She represents the "modern" life Ananse's money has bought him.
5. **THE CHIEFS (Unseen):** They are revealed through their messengers. Most are as greedy and selfish as Ananse. **Chief-who-is-Chief** is the only one shown to be genuinely generous and honourable.

3.4 THEMES

1. **CUNNING AND TRICKERY AS A SURVIVAL TOOL:** This is the central theme. The play explores how the "small man" (Ananse) can defeat the "big men" (the Chiefs) not with power or money, but with his *brain*.
2. **TRADITION VS. MODERNITY:** Ananse is the perfect blend of both. He uses a *traditional* storytelling format (*Anansem*) and a *traditional* marriage custom (dowry) but uses *modern* technology (photos, typewriters, telegrams) to run his scam.
3. **POVERTY AND GREED:** The entire plot is motivated by Ananse's "ragged-clothed poverty." His greed for a better life drives him to trickery. The play also satirizes the greed of the chiefs.
4. **THE ROLE/POSITION OF WOMEN:** The play critiques how women are "marketed" for marriage. Ananse literally calls his daughter "a new-coined currency." She is an object to be sold to the highest bidder.

EVALUATION

1. What "crisis" forces Ananse to invent a new plan in Act Two?
2. What is Ananse's new, more drastic plan?
3. How does the "funeral" in Act Three become a "test" for the chiefs?
4. Who is the only chief who passes the test, and how?
5. Explain the theme of "Tradition vs. Modernity" in the play.

ASSIGNMENT

1. Write a detailed **character analysis** of Kweku Ananse. In your opinion, is he a hero or a villain? (Two paragraphs).
2. Do you think Ananewa is a weak or a strong character? Use evidence from the play to support your view.

WEEK 4: AFRICAN DRAMA

TOPIC: "THE MARRIAGE OF ANANSEWA" (STYLE & MORAL LESSONS)

4.1 DRAMATIC STYLE: THE *ANANSESEM*

The most important aspect of the play's style is its faithful recreation of an *Anansem* performance.

1. **THE ROLE OF THE STORYTELLER:** The play is not a "realistic" story. It is a story *being told to us*. The Storyteller opens the play, introduces the characters, interrupts the action to speak to the audience (e.g., "Well, well, well, Ananse is in a real fix, isn't he?"), and closes the play. He *stages* the story for us.
2. **AUDIENCE PARTICIPATION:** The Storyteller and Ananse frequently "break the fourth wall" (the imaginary wall between the stage and the audience). They talk to the audience, ask them questions, and make them "conspirators" in the plot. We *want* Ananse to succeed.
3. **EPISODIC STRUCTURE:** The play is not one long, continuous story. It is built in short, clear "episodes" or scenes, just like a folktale:
 - Episode 1: The Plan.
 - Episode 2: The Gifts.
 - Episode 3: The Crisis.
 - Episode 4: The Fake Death.
 - Episode 5: The Funeral Test.
 - Episode 6: The Miracle.
4. **MMOMOME (THE SONGS):** This is a key *Anansem* technique. The play is interrupted by "pure-cast songs" sung by a chorus. These songs are not part of the plot; they are *commentaries* on it. They set the mood, reflect on Ananse's greed, or transition us from one scene to the next.
5. **LANGUAGE:** The language is simple, direct, and poetic. It is full of powerful imagery (Anansewa as "a new-coined currency," "a-glitter-in-the-sun") and traditional wisdom.

4.2 MORAL LESSONS AND AMBIGUITY

Unlike a simple European fable (e.g., "The Boy Who Cried Wolf," where the moral is "don't lie"), the moral of a trickster tale is **ambiguous** (unclear).

- **Does Ananse get punished?** No. He wins. He ends the play rich, respected, and with the best son-in-law imaginable.
- **What is the moral?** The play is not a simple "morality play." It does not say "Do not be greedy" or "Do not lie."
- **Instead, the play...**
 1. **Celebrates Intelligence:** It celebrates cunning and resourcefulness. It says that the *mind* is the most powerful weapon, especially for the poor and powerless.
 2. **Satirizes Society:** The play is a **satire**. It makes fun of a society that is greedy. The chiefs are *also* greedy (they want a beautiful wife), and Ananse simply uses their own greed against them.
 3. **Critiques the "Marriage Market":** The play is a subtle critique of a system where daughters are "sold" like property. Ananse just takes this cultural practice to its logical, absurd extreme.

The "moral" is not a simple lesson. The "moral" is the act of storytelling itself—the joy of watching a clever trickster outsmart the world.

EVALUATION

1. What is the "fourth wall," and how does this play "break" it?
2. What is the purpose of the *Mmomome* (songs) in the play?
3. Explain what "Episodic Structure" means.
4. What is a "satire"? What is Efua Sutherland satirizing in this play?
5. What is the main *difference* between the moral of a trickster tale and the moral of a simple fable?

ASSIGNMENT

1. Write two paragraphs on the **style** of *The Marriage of Anansewa*. How does Efua Sutherland use the Storyteller and the *Mmomome* to create a uniquely African play?

2. "Ananse is a terrible father and a criminal, and he should have been arrested." Do you agree or disagree with this statement? Justify your answer.



WEEK 5: MIDTERM EXAMINATION

(This week is for the assessment of all topics covered in Weeks 1-4. No new lesson notes.)



WEEK 6: NON-AFRICAN DRAMA

TOPIC: ROBERT BOLT – "A MAN FOR ALL SEASONS"

6.1 ABOUT THE PLAYWRIGHT: ROBERT BOLT (1924-1995)

Robert Bolt was an English playwright and screenwriter, famous for his historical dramas. He was not a historian; he was a *moralist*. He used historical figures to explore modern, universal themes of conscience, integrity, and corruption.

6.2 HISTORICAL BACKGROUND (THE CONTEXT IS ESSENTIAL)

You *cannot* understand this play without knowing the history.

- **Time:** England, 1530s.
- **The King:** King Henry VIII.
- **The "King's Great Matter":** Henry is married to **Catherine of Aragon**. They have one daughter, Mary, but **no son** (no male heir). Henry believes the marriage is cursed and wants to marry **Anne Boleyn**, with whom he is in love.
- **The Problem:** England is a **Catholic** country. The **Pope** in Rome is the Head of the Church and is the only one who can grant a divorce (annulment). The Pope, for political reasons, *refuses*.
- **The "Solution":** Henry decides to break away from the Catholic Church. He has Parliament pass the **Act of Supremacy**.
- **The Act of Supremacy:** This act declared that the King (Henry), not the Pope, was the supreme Head of the Church in England.
- **The Oath:** To enforce this, all citizens in positions of power (bishops, lawyers, officials) were required to swear an **oath** agreeing to the Act.
- **This is the "test" of the play.** To swear the oath is to save your life but betray your God. To *refuse* to swear is to stay loyal to your God but be executed for **Treason**.

6.3 THE PROTAGONIST: SIR THOMAS MORE

The "man for all seasons" is **Sir Thomas More**.

- He was a real person: a brilliant lawyer, a devout Catholic, and a "humanist" (a Renaissance scholar).
- He was the **Lord Chancellor** of England—the highest-ranking official in the kingdom, second only to the King. He was also a close, personal friend of Henry VIII.
- **His Problem:** More is a man of unshakable conscience. He is loyal to his King, *but* he is loyal to his God *first*. He *cannot* and *will not* swear the oath.

6.4 SETTING

- **Physical:** 16th-century London. Key locations: More's home in Chelsea (a place of warmth, family, and ideas), Hampton Court (the palace of power), and the Tower of London (a prison).
- **Atmospheric:** The mood changes from one of political intrigue and intellectual debate to one of fear, paranoia, and danger.

6.5 SUMMARY OF ACTS ONE & TWO (Abridged)

(Note: The play is structured as two long acts)

ACT ONE (The Pressure Builds):

- We meet **Sir Thomas More**. He is witty, moral, and happy with his family (his wife **Alice**, his daughter **Meg**, and her suitor **Roper**).
- We meet **Richard Rich**, a young, ambitious man looking for a job. More doesn't trust him and offers him a safe, moral job as a teacher. Rich is insulted; he wants power.
- We meet **Thomas Cromwell**, the "villain." He is a practical, ruthless politician who is helping the King get his divorce.
- Cardinal Wolsey (the *old* Chancellor) fails to get the divorce from the Pope and dies in disgrace.
- The King makes More the new Lord Chancellor, hoping More's "honest" reputation will help his case.
- The **Act of Supremacy** is passed. More, knowing he cannot support it, tries to resign. The King is furious.

- More falls from power. He is now a private citizen, but he is *not safe*.

ACT TWO (The Trap Closes):

- More is now poor, but he is firm. His "defence" is **SILENCE**. He believes if he *says nothing* against the King's Act, the law cannot *legally* touch him.
- Cromwell is determined to break him. He "invites" More for questioning, trying to trap him into speaking. More remains silent.
- More's family is terrified. They beg him to just *say the words* of the oath, even if he doesn't mean them. More refuses, explaining his conscience *is* his "self."
- **The Betrayal:** Cromwell has Rich arrested on false charges and offers him a *deal*: "Give me false evidence against More, and I will make you powerful."
- **The Trial (Climax):** More is arrested and tried for treason. He defends himself brilliantly, using the law. He is about to be acquitted...
- ...until **Richard Rich** is called to the stand. Rich commits **perjury** (lies under oath). He swears he heard More *deny* the King's supremacy (which More never did).
- More is found guilty. His "silence" is broken by Rich's *lie*.
- **The End:** More is executed, but he dies as "the King's good servant, but God's first."

EVALUATION

1. What was the "King's Great Matter" that King Henry VIII faced?
2. What was the **Act of Supremacy**?
3. Who is Sir Thomas More, and what is his job at the *start* of the play?
4. Why does More *refuse* to swear the oath?
5. What is More's "defence" against his enemies? (Hint: It is an *action*).
6. Who is Richard Rich, and what does he do to More at the trial?

ASSIGNMENT

1. Write two paragraphs explaining the **central conflict** of the play. What two things are in conflict, and what does More have to choose between?

2. Based on this summary, who is the **antagonist** (villain) of the play? Is it the King, Cromwell, or Rich? Justify your choice.



WEEK 7: MIDTERM BREAK

(This week is a break. No new lesson notes.)



WEEK 8: NON-AFRICAN DRAMA

TOPIC: "A MAN FOR ALL SEASONS" (THEMES & STYLE)

8.1 THEMES

1. **CONSCIENCE AND INTEGRITY VS. DUTY TO THE STATE:** This is the **central theme**. The play is a masterpiece on the conflict between personal morality and public duty.
 - **More** represents the man who believes his primary duty is to his own conscience (his "self," his "God").
 - **Cromwell, Rich,** and **Norfolk** represent the men who believe their primary duty is to the King (the State).
 - The play asks: What do you do when your country's law is *immoral*?
2. **IDENTITY AND THE "SELF":** More equates his conscience with his very *identity*. He explains to his daughter that when a man swears an oath, he "holds his 'self' in his own hands. Like water. And if he opens his fingers *then*—he needn't hope to find himself again."
 - To swear the oath would be, for More, a form of *suicide*. He would rather die *physically* as "Thomas More" than live *spiritually* as a hollow man who has betrayed his own core.
3. **CORRUPTION BY AMBITION:** The play is a study of how ambition corrupts.
 - **Richard Rich** is the "A-B-C" of corruption. He starts as an ambitious job-seeker, tells small lies, and ends by *selling his soul* (committing perjury) for political power (becoming Attorney-General for Wales). More says, "It profits a man nothing to give his soul for the whole world... but for Wales, Richard?"
4. **THE LAW, JUSTICE, AND SILENCE:** More is a *lawyer*. He loves the law and believes it is a "fortress" that protects society.
 - He tries to use the law (and his *silence*) as a shield.
 - The **tragedy** of the play is that the "villains" (Cromwell) *use the law* as a *weapon* to *destroy* him. The play shows that the law can be a tool for *injustice* if the people who wield it are corrupt.

8.2 CHARACTERIZATION

1. **SIR THOMAS MORE (The Protagonist):** A man of absolute integrity. He is *not* a "saint" in the traditional sense; he is witty, sharp, a brilliant lawyer, and terrified of death. This makes his final stand *more* heroic, because he is a *real man*, not a fearless statue.
2. **THOMAS CROMWELL (The Antagonist):** The "modern man." He is a practical, ruthless, and efficient politician. He has no personal morals or conscience; he simply *gets the job done* for the King. He is the *opposite* of More.
3. **RICHARD RICH (The Symbol of Corruption):** A weak, pathetic man. He has no core. He just wants power and wealth. He is a 'lesser' villain than Cromwell, but his betrayal is the one that *legally* kills More.
4. **THE COMMON MAN (The Stylistic Device):** This is a *character* who plays many small roles: More's Butler, a Boatman, a Jailer, the Foreman of the Jury.
 - **Function:** He represents the "common people" who are *not* heroic. They just want to "do their job," "not get involved," and "stay out of trouble."
 - **Significance:** Bolt uses him to show that it is this *common apathy* that *allows* evil to happen. The Common Man (as the jury) is the one who finds More guilty.

8.3 DRAMATIC STYLE

- **HISTORICAL DRAMA:** The play uses a real historical event to explore timeless moral questions.
- **ALIENATION EFFECT (BRECHTIAN TECHNIQUE):** The "Common Man" is a key part of this.
 - He "breaks the fourth wall" to talk *directly to the audience*.
 - He changes costumes *on stage*.
 - **Purpose:** This reminds the audience, "This is a play, not reality." Bolt does not want the audience to *cry* (feel emotion); he wants them to *think* (judge the situation). He wants the audience to ask *themselves*: "What would *I* have done?"

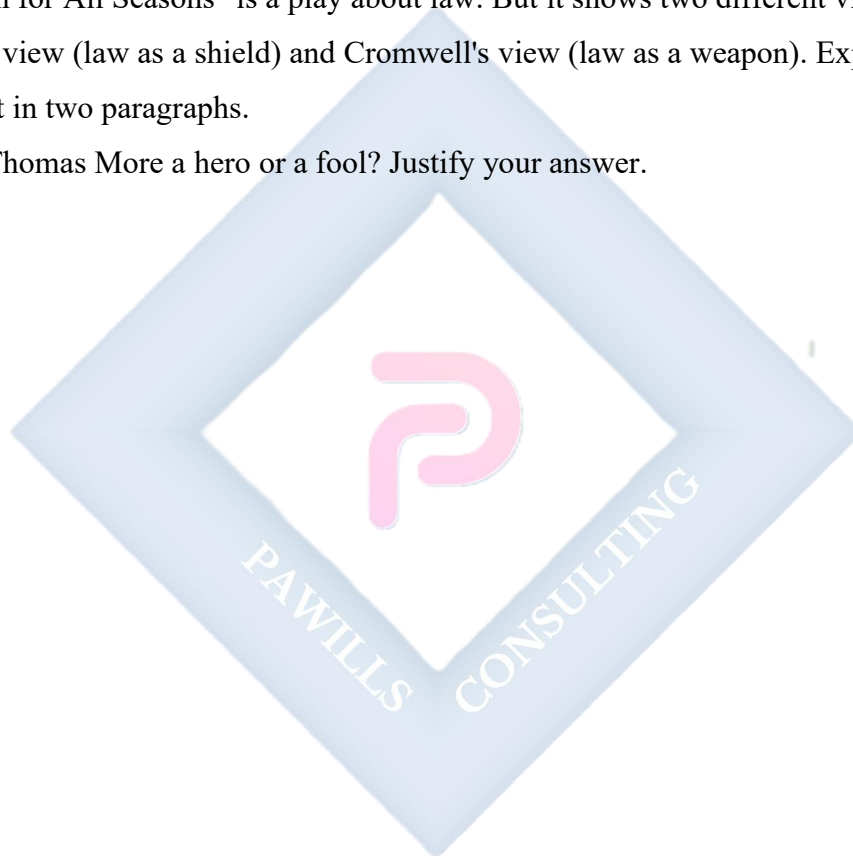
EVALUATION

1. What is the central theme of the play?

2. Explain More's metaphor of holding "water" (his "self") in his hands.
3. How does the character of Richard Rich represent the theme of "Corruption by Ambition"?
4. Who is the "Common Man," and what is his dramatic function in the play?
5. What is the "Alienation Effect"? How is it used in this play?

ASSIGNMENT

1. "A Man for All Seasons" is a play about law. But it shows two different views of law: More's view (law as a shield) and Cromwell's view (law as a weapon). Explain this conflict in two paragraphs.
2. Is Sir Thomas More a hero or a fool? Justify your answer.



WEEK 9: NON-AFRICAN DRAMA

TOPIC: J.B. PRIESTLEY – "AN INSPECTOR CALLS"

9.1 ABOUT THE PLAYWRIGHT: J.B. PRIESTLEY (1894-1984)

J.B. Priestley was a British novelist, commentator, and playwright. He was a committed **socialist**. He was very concerned with social inequality and the class system in Britain. His work (like this play) is often a "morality play"—a play with a strong, clear moral message.

9.2 BACKGROUND AND SETTING (CRUCIAL)

- **WHEN IT WAS WRITTEN:** 1945. This is *after* two World Wars. Britain was rebuilding, and the old class system was breaking down. Priestley was writing to advocate for a new, more equal **socialist** Britain.
- **WHEN IT IS SET:** 1912. This is *before* the World Wars. This was the "golden age" of capitalism, but also a time of massive inequality.
- **WHY THE DATES MATTER:** Priestley deliberately sets the play in 1912 to *expose* the attitudes of the past. The Birlings, a wealthy upper-middle-class family, are happy in their "bubble" and feel no responsibility for anyone else.
- **The Play is a PARABLE:** It's a simple story designed to teach a moral lesson about **social responsibility**.

9.3 PLOT SUMMARY

ACT ONE:

- **The Scene:** The Birling family (Arthur, Sybil, daughter Sheila, son Eric) and Sheila's fiancé, **Gerald Croft**, are having a dinner party to celebrate the engagement.
- **Mr. Birling's Speech:** Arthur Birling gives a speech full of selfish, capitalist, and *wrong* advice. He says "a man has to mind his own business and look after himself and his own." He makes several **dramatically ironic** statements: he calls the **Titanic** "unsinkable" and says there is "no chance of war." (The 1945 audience knows he is a fool).

- **The Interruption:** An "Inspector Goole" arrives. He says a young working-class girl, **Eva Smith**, has just died at the infirmary by drinking disinfectant.
- **The Chain of Events (Part 1):** The Inspector reveals that **Mr. Birling** knew her. He fired her from his factory two years ago for being a "ringleader" in a strike for a small pay raise.
- **The Chain of Events (Part 2):** He then reveals that **Sheila** knew her. A year later, Eva Smith (working in a shop) was fired because Sheila, in a bad mood, complained about her. Sheila is *horrified* and accepts her guilt.

ACT TWO:

- **The Chain of Events (Part 3):** The Inspector turns to **Gerald**. He reveals that Eva (now calling herself "Daisy Renton") was Gerald's mistress. He kept her as a "pet" for a summer and then abandoned her. Gerald is ashamed.
- **The Chain of Events (Part 4):** The Inspector turns to **Mrs. Birling (Sybil)**. She is cold, snobbish, and refuses to accept any blame. She admits she is the head of a women's charity. A pregnant Eva/Daisy came to her for help. Mrs. Birling, offended by the girl, *refused* to help her. She callously tells the Inspector that the *father* of the unborn child is the *only* one "responsible."

ACT THREE:

- **The Chain of Events (Part 5):** The "father" is revealed. **Eric Birling**, the son, confesses. He had a drunken affair with the girl, got her pregnant, and then *stole* money from his father's office to try and help her.
- **The Inspector's Final Speech:** The "chain of events" is complete. Each Birling (and Gerald) gave one "push" that led Eva Smith to suicide. The Inspector delivers the play's main message: "We are members of one body. We are responsible for each other... if men will not learn that lesson, then they will be taught it in fire and blood and anguish." He leaves.
- **THE FIRST TWIST:** The family is shaken. They start to wonder if he was a *real* inspector. Gerald phones the police. **There is no "Inspector Goole" on the force.**

- **THE SECOND TWIST:** Mr. Birling phones the hospital. **No girl has died from disinfectant.**
- **The Result:** The parents (Arthur and Sybil) and Gerald are *delighted*. They believe it was a "hoax." They laugh and go "back to normal," having *learned nothing*.
- **The Divide:** The children (Sheila and Eric) are still horrified. They argue that it *doesn't matter* if he was real or if the girl died. The *actions* they committed are still true. They *have* learned their lesson.
- **THE FINAL TWIST:** The telephone rings. Mr. Birling answers. It is the *real* police. A girl *has just died* on her way to the hospital after drinking disinfectant. An inspector is on his way. The play ends on this cliffhanger.

9.4 CHARACTER ANALYSIS

- **INSPECTOR GOOLE:** The *protagonist* or *catalyst*. He is not a real person. He is a supernatural force, a "ghoul," a "spirit of conscience," or Priestley's **socialist mouthpiece**. He comes to *teach a lesson*.
- **MR. BIRLING:** The "Old Generation." Arrogant, selfish, capitalist. **Static Character** (he does not change).
- **MRS. BIRLING:** The "Old Generation." Cold, snobbish, cruel. **Static Character**.
- **SHEILA BIRLING:** The "Young Generation." Starts as "giddy" and materialistic. She is the first to accept her guilt and changes completely. **Dynamic Character**.
- **ERIC BIRLING:** The "Young Generation." Weak, "half-drunk," but he feels guilt. **Dynamic Character**.
- **GERALD CROFT:** In the middle. He feels guilty (more than the parents), but he is too eager to believe the "hoax" and sides with the Old Generation.
- **EVA SMITH (DAISY RENTON):** The silent victim. She never appears, but she is the centre of the play. She represents the *entire working class*.

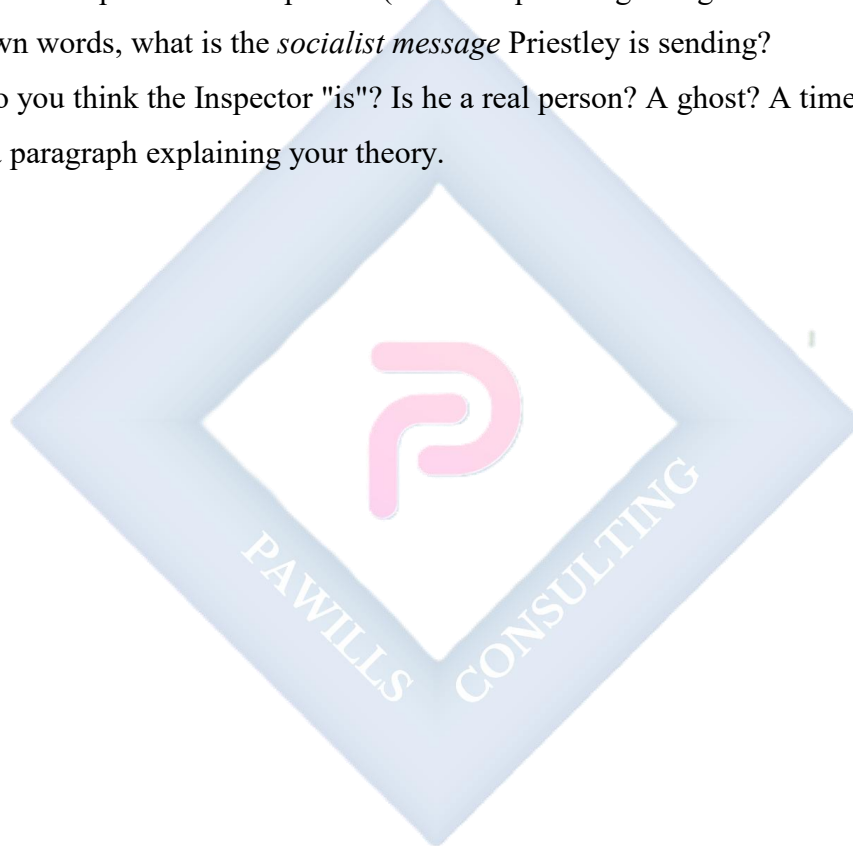
EVALUATION

1. Why is the *setting* (written in 1945, set in 1912) so important?
2. What is "dramatic irony," and what is the best example of it in Act One?

3. List the "chain of events." What did *each* of the five main characters (Birling, Sheila, Gerald, Mrs. B, Eric) do to Eva Smith?
4. What is the *moral difference* between the "Old Generation" (parents) and the "Young Generation" (children) at the end of the play?
5. What is the "Final Twist," and what does it mean?

ASSIGNMENT

1. What is the Inspector's final speech? (Find the quote beginning "We are members..."). In your own words, what is the *socialist message* Priestley is sending?
2. Who do you think the Inspector "is"? Is he a real person? A ghost? A time-traveler? God? Write a paragraph explaining your theory.



WEEK 10: NON-AFRICAN DRAMA

TOPIC: "AN INSPECTOR CALLS" (THEMES & TECHNIQUES)

10.1 THEMES

1. **SOCIAL RESPONSIBILITY (COLLECTIVE RESPONSIBILITY):** This is the **central theme**. The play is a direct attack on the capitalist idea of "every man for himself." Priestley's message is that all members of a society are *linked* and *responsible* for one another. The Inspector's "chain of events" shows how the Birlings' "private" actions had *public* and fatal consequences.
2. **CLASS WARFARE (SOCIAL CLASS):** The play is a critique of the British class system. The Birlings (upper-middle class) believe they are superior to Eva Smith (working class). They exploit her for cheap labour (Mr. Birling), fire her for their own amusement (Sheila), use her for sex (Eric, Gerald), and deny her charity (Mrs. Birling). The play exposes the *hypocrisy* of the "respectable" upper classes.
3. **THE "OLD" VS. "YOUNG" GENERATION:** Priestley shows a "battle" for the future.
 - **Old (Mr. & Mrs. Birling):** Are "static." They are "un-teachable" and "set in their ways." They represent the "bad" past (1912).
 - **Young (Sheila & Eric):** Are "dynamic." They are open to change, feel guilt, and accept responsibility. They represent Priestley's *hope* for a new, socialist future (1945).
4. **HYPOCRISY:** The play exposes the hypocrisy of the Birling family. They are obsessed with their "respectable" public image, but behind closed doors, their family is built on secrets, exploitation, and cruelty.

10.2 DRAMATIC TECHNIQUES

1. **THE "WELL-MADE PLAY" (WITH A TWIST):** A "well-made play" was a popular form that had a tight, logical plot that builds to a climax. Priestley uses this structure, but then *subverts* (undermines) it with his supernatural twists.
2. **THE THREE UNITIES:** The play follows the "three unities" (a classical idea):
 - **Unity of Action:** One single plot (the investigation).

- **Unity of Time:** The action happens in "real time" (over about two hours).
 - **Unity of Place:** The entire play is set in *one room* (the Birlings' dining room).
 - **Effect:** This makes the play feel very *intense* and *claustrophobic*. The characters (and the audience) are *trapped* and cannot escape the Inspector's questions.
3. **DRAMATIC IRONY:** As covered in Week 9, this is Priestley's main tool for discrediting Mr. Birling. When Birling says the *Titanic* is "unsinkable" and there is "no chance of war," the 1945 audience knows he is a fool. Therefore, when he says, "a man has to look after himself," the audience knows *that* is foolish, too.
4. **THE INSPECTOR AS A DRAMATIC DEVICE:**
- He is a *catalyst*. He arrives, starts the "chain of events," and leaves.
 - He controls the plot. He questions them *one by one*, in a specific order, to build the tension.
5. **THE CYCLICAL STRUCTURE (THE FINAL TWIST):** The play ends where it begins. The first "inspection" was a *warning*. Now, the *real* inspection is about to begin. The final phone call is a brilliant *coup de théâtre* (stroke of theatre). It gives the characters (and the audience) a "second chance" to decide how they will act.

10.3 MORAL AND SOCIAL SIGNIFICANCE

This play is a **Morality Play** for the modern era. A "morality play" (from the Middle Ages) was a play where a hero (like "Everyman") is visited by characters (like "Death," "Greed," or "Good Deeds") who try to teach him a lesson.

In this play:

- The **Birling family** is "Everyman" (or "Every-Family").
- **Inspector Goole** is the character (like "Conscience" or "Socialism") who comes to teach them a lesson.
- The lesson is simple: **We are all "members of one body."**

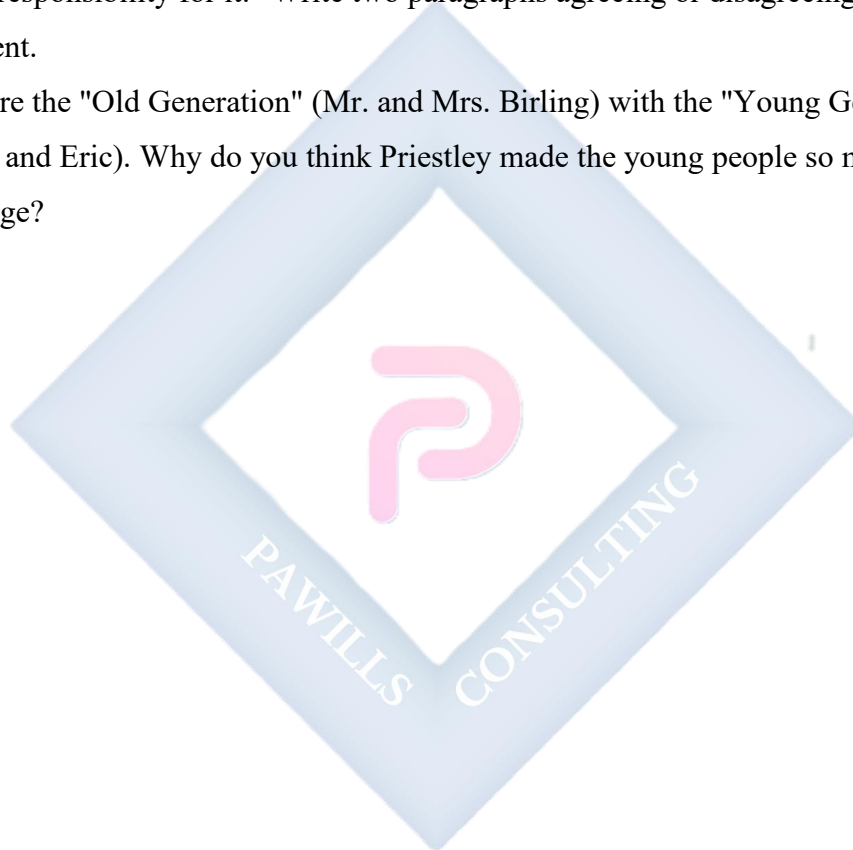
EVALUATION

1. What is the central theme of "An Inspector Calls"?

2. Explain the "Three Unities" and the *effect* they have on the play's atmosphere.
3. Why is the "Old vs. Young" generation divide so important to Priestley's message?
4. How is this play a "Morality Play"? Who is "Everyman" and who is "Conscience"?
5. What is a "cyclical structure," and how does it operate in this play?

ASSIGNMENT

1. "In 'An Inspector Calls,' the real 'crime' is not what the Birlings did, but their refusal to accept responsibility for it." Write two paragraphs agreeing or disagreeing with this statement.
2. Compare the "Old Generation" (Mr. and Mrs. Birling) with the "Young Generation" (Sheila and Eric). Why do you think Priestley made the young people so much more open to change?



WEEK 11: REVISION

TOPIC: GENERAL REVIEW OF ALL DRAMA TEXTS AND POEMS

This week is dedicated to a comprehensive review of the three plays studied this term, as well as a brief review of the poems from the First Term.

11.1 REVIEW OF DRAMA: COMPARATIVE ANALYSIS

The best way to revise is to compare the plays.

Feature	The Marriage of Anansewa (Sutherland)	A Man for All Seasons (Bolt)	An Inspector Calls (Priestley)
Genre	African Folk-Drama (Anansem)	Non-African Historical Drama	Non-African Morality Play / "Well-Made Play"
Protagonist	Ananse (The Trickster)	Sir Thomas More (The Martyr)	Inspector Goole (The Catalyst / Mouthpiece)
Central Conflict	Cunning vs. Power. Ananse (the "small man") uses his wits to get rich and beat the "big men."	Conscience vs. The State. A man of integrity refuses to betray his God, even if it means death.	Socialism vs. Capitalism. The idea of "collective responsibility" challenges the "every man for himself" worldview.
Key Theme(s)	Cunning, Tradition vs. Modernity, Greed.	Integrity, Conscience, Law, Corruption.	Social Responsibility, Class Warfare, Old vs. Young.
Dramatic Style	Breaks "fourth wall": Storyteller, songs, audience participation. Highly stylized.	Breaks "fourth wall": The "Common Man" (Alienation Effect). Historical, intellectual.	Follows "three unities": One room, real-time, intense, claustrophobic. "Realistic" (with a supernatural twist).
The "Moral"	Ambiguous: Cunning is celebrated. It's a <i>satire</i>	Absolute: It is better to die as "yourself" than	Direct: "We are members of one body." We <i>must</i> be

	that critiques greed by showing a trickster win.	live as a man with no conscience. Integrity is priceless.	responsible for each other, or society is doomed.
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11.2 REVIEW OF POEMS (FROM FIRST TERM)

- This is a good time to quickly review the key themes and devices from the poems studied in the First Term.
- **AFRICAN POETRY:**
 - **"Once Upon a Time" (Okara):** Loss of innocence, hypocrisy of modernity. (Metaphor: "ice-block-cold eyes").
 - **"Night" (Soyinka):** Power of nature, loss of self. (Metaphor: "receptive womb").
 - **"Not My Business" (Osundare):** Political apathy. (Refrain: "Not my business").
 - **"The Breast of the Sea" (Cheney-Coker):** Ancestral memory, the diaspora. (Metaphor: "breast of the sea").
- **NON-AFRICAN POETRY:**
 - **"Still I Rise" (Angelou):** Resilience, empowerment. (Refrain: "Still I'll rise").
 - **"She Walks in Beauty" (Byron):** Harmony of inner and outer beauty. (Simile: "like the night").
 - **"Digging" (Heaney):** Heritage, craft of writing. (Metaphor: "I'll dig with it").
 - **"The Telephone Call" (Adcock):** Modern alienation, superficiality. (Tone: sarcastic).

EVALUATION (FINAL REVISION)

1. Compare the protagonists: Ananse vs. Sir Thomas More. How are they both "smart," but in different ways?
2. Compare the "villains": The Chiefs (in *Anansewa*) vs. Cromwell/Rich (in *A Man for All Seasons*) vs. The Birlings (in *An Inspector Calls*).
3. Which of the three plays has the *clearest* moral message? Which has the most *ambiguous*? Explain.

4. How do *The Marriage of Anansewa* and *A Man for All Seasons* both use a character to "break the fourth wall"? (Hint: Storyteller vs. Common Man). What is the *purpose* of this technique in each play?
5. What is the central theme of "Not My Business," and how does it relate to the central theme of "An Inspector Calls"?

FINAL TERM ASSIGNMENT (ESSAY PROMPT)

Choose *two* of the plays studied this term. Compare and contrast how they explore the theme of **"Morality and Justice."**

- (Think about: What is "justice" in *Anansewa*? What is "justice" in *A Man for All Seasons*? What is "justice" in *An Inspector Calls*? Is it legal justice or moral justice?)

